TA

Trinix Admission

User Manual: Centralised Admission Management System

For admission staff, committee members, faculty (panel members) and system administrators
Version 1.0 · November 2026

One application for every campus, course and round. Trinix Admission brings the shortlisted applicants in from the admission portal, schedules their GD and PI, lets panels mark on phones and tablets, and produces the merit list.

Applicants never sign in. Staff record every response, and the system sends all notices to applicants by email.

The screens in this manual show sample data from a test system. Names, numbers and marks in them are not real, and the formulas shown are test values, not the institute's rules.

Contents

1. Introduction
What the system does, who uses it, the admission workflow

2. Getting started
Signing in, two-factor sign-in, the screen layout, your account

3. Setup
Institution, campuses, locations, courses, cycles and rounds

4. People
Users, importing faculty, roles and permissions, teams

5. Applicants and imports
Sources, importing the shortlist, applicants' files (optional), applications

6. Interviews (GD/PI)
The stage map, stages and marks, the Excel schedule, panels, automatic assignment, emails, rescheduling, locking

7. Marking interviews (for panel members)
My interviews on a phone or tablet, submitting

8. Merit
Merit formula, running, approving and publishing merit lists; reports and exports

9. System administration
Installation, updates, health, settings, audit log

10. Roles at a glance
Who can do what

11. Questions and troubleshooting
Common questions, terms used

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

Trinix Admission is the admission office's system for everything that happens **after** applicants apply on the institute's admission portal. It is one installation and one database for all campuses (Delhi, Kolkata, Kakinada, GIFT City) and all courses (MBA (IB), MBA (BA), IPM and others).

The admission workflow

1. **Setup:** the institution, campuses, interview venues (locations), courses, which campus offers which course, the admission cycle and the rounds with dates for each campus.
2. **Import students:** the shortlisted applicants of a round come from the portal's Excel/CSV export (or through its API), are checked, previewed and approved by a second person. Everyone imported into a round is a GD/PI candidate.
3. **Import files (optional):** applicants' documents as a ZIP file or as links from the portal, virus-scanned.
4. **Import faculty:** panel members from an Excel/CSV file.
5. **Interview schedule:** dates, panels, venues, slots and members from an Excel template (or by hand).
6. **Assign:** run the simulation to assign candidates to slots and faculty to panels (preview first), change anything by hand, then **send the schedule emails**. Staff reschedule when needed.
7. **GD, then PI on a different panel:** attendance and marks on phones and tablets. After an in-person GD, the PI is at the same venue.
8. **Lock:** the admin locks the marks, for a whole stage, panel or day at once.
9. **Merit:** the merit formula turns each candidate's results into a total and a rank. A second person approves and publishes the list, which can be exported to Excel or PDF.

Principles you will notice

- **Nothing is saved without a check.** Imports, the interview schedule, automatic assignments and merit lists are always shown as a preview first.
- **Two people for important steps.** The person who uploads an import or runs a merit list cannot approve or publish it.
- **Everything is recorded.** Every change is written to the audit log with who, when, what changed and why.
- **Rules are entered by the institute.** Marking criteria, stage formulas and the merit formula are never built into the software; authorised staff enter them and approve them with a source.
- **You see only your scope.** Each person sees only the campuses, courses and cycles their role covers. Panel members see only their own candidates.

- **Email only.** All notices to applicants go by email; there is no SMS. Applicants reply by phone or email, and staff act on it (e.g. reschedule).

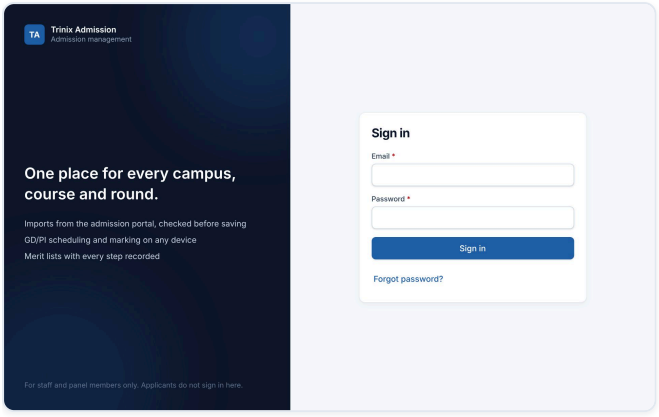
CHAPTER 2

Getting started

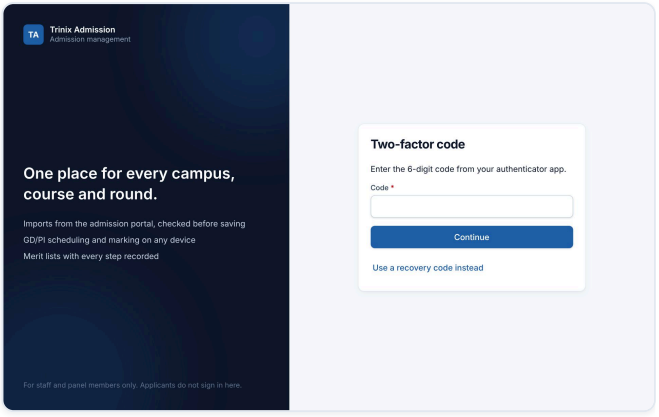
Your account

You receive an **invitation email** from the system. Open the link, choose a password (at least 12 characters), and sign in with your email address and that password. Invitations expire after a few days; if yours has expired, ask your administrator to resend it.

Signing in



The sign-in page



The two-factor code step

Two-factor sign-in

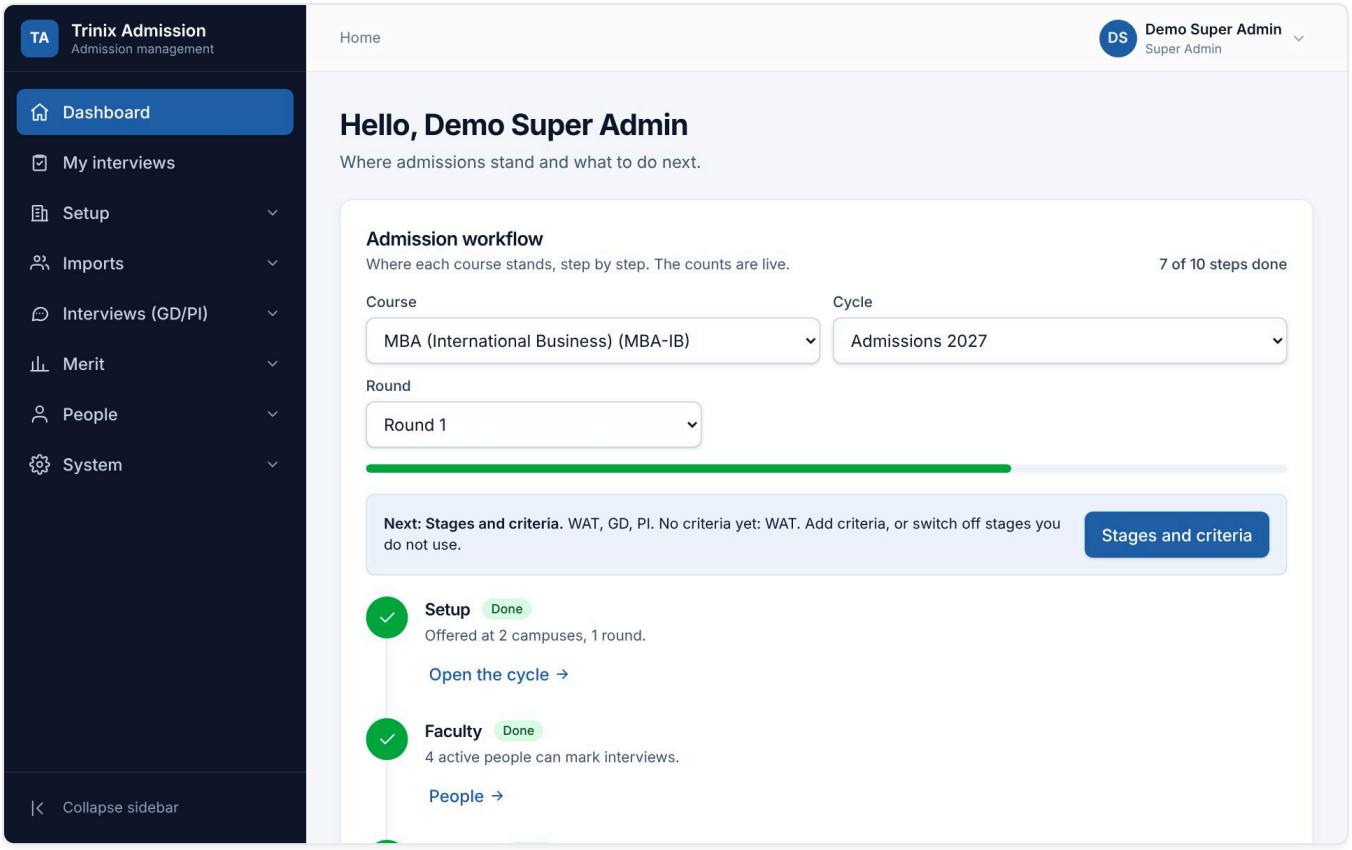
Administrators (Super Admin, IT Administrator, Central Admission Administrator, Branch Administrator) must use **two-factor sign-in**. At your first sign-in you are taken to **Account** to set it up:

1. Install an authenticator app on your phone (for example Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator).
2. Click **Set up two-factor**, confirm your password, and scan the QR code with the app.
3. Type the 6-digit code the app shows, click **Turn on**, and **save the recovery codes** somewhere safe. Each one lets you sign in once if you lose your phone.

After that, each sign-in asks for your password and then the current 6-digit code.

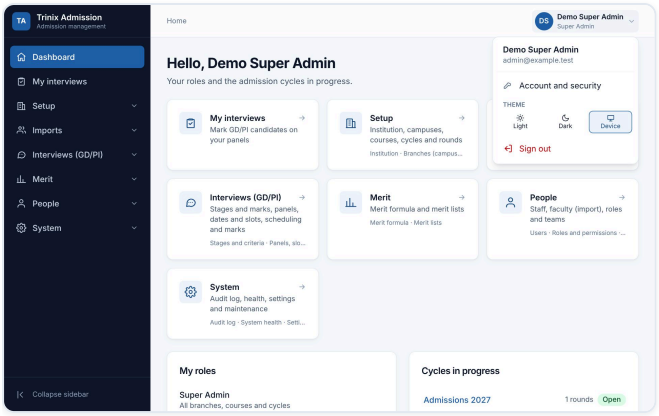
> Forgot your password? Use **Forgot password?** on the sign-in page; a reset link is emailed to you. After several wrong passwords the account locks for a short time; an IT Administrator can unlock it.

The screen layout

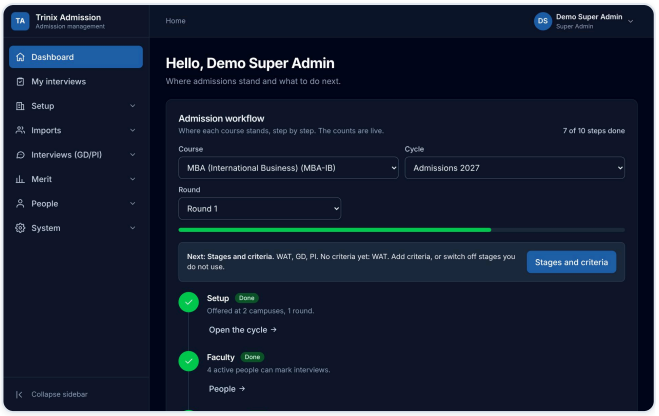


The dashboard, with the sidebar menu on the left and the top bar

- **Sidebar menu (left):** the modules in the order of the admission work. Click a group (for example **Interviews (GD/PI)**) to open its sub-menu; the page you are on is highlighted. You see only the items your role allows.
- **Collapse sidebar:** at the bottom of the sidebar on a computer, this shows icons only to give more room. Click any icon to open the menu again.
- **Top bar:** shows where you are (for example *Home › Interviews (GD/PI) › Panels, slots and schedule*). Click a part of the path to go back to it.
- **Your name (top right):** opens the account menu, with Account and security, the **theme** (Light, Dark or Device, which follows your phone or computer) and **Sign out**.
- **Dashboard:** the **Admission workflow** for a course and round (below), today's interviews for panel members, shortcut cards for each module you can use, your roles, and the cycles in progress.



The account menu with the theme switch

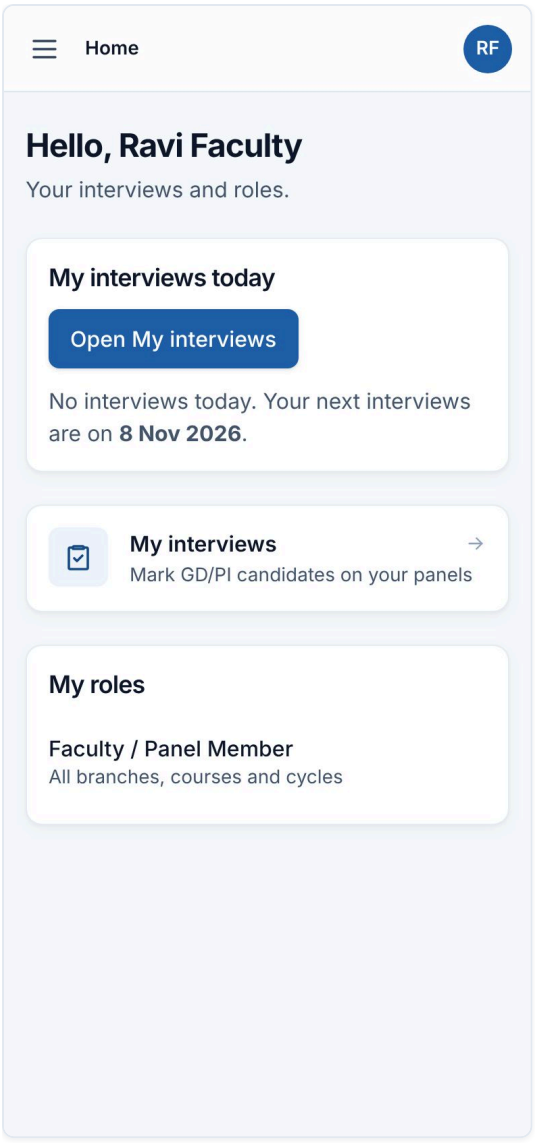


The dark theme

The admission workflow

The top of the dashboard follows one course in one round through every step: **Setup, Faculty, Students, Applicants' files** (optional), **Stages and criteria, Interview schedule, Schedule emails, Attendance and marks, Lock results** and the **Merit list**. Choose the course, cycle and round; each step shows live counts (for example "GD: 2 panels, 45 of 50 scheduled") and a link to the screen where it is done. The box at the top names the **next step**.

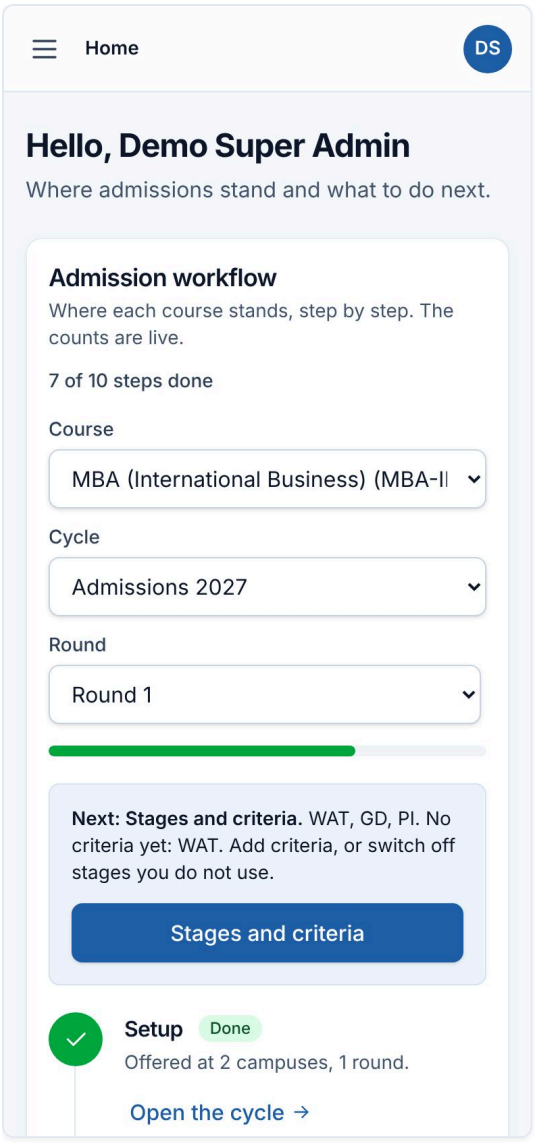
- **Done** (green tick), **To do**, **Needs attention** (amber: something is waiting, such as an import to approve or candidates not yet emailed), **Not yet** (an earlier step must come first) and **Optional**.
- The course, cycle and round you choose are remembered on other screens of this browser until you sign out.
- Panel members see **My interviews today** instead: their panels, how many candidates they have marked, or the date of their next interviews.



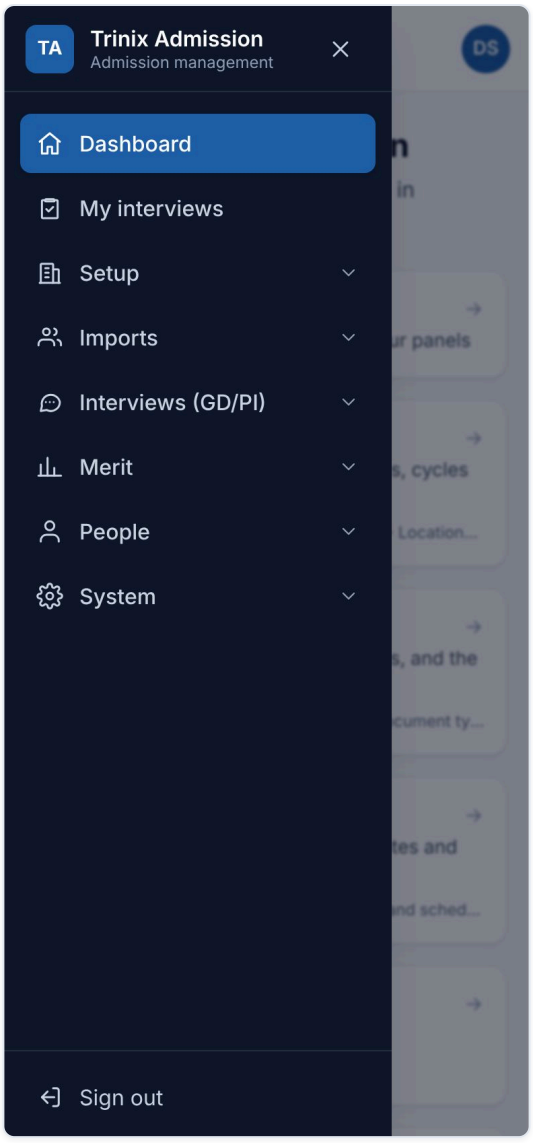
A panel member's dashboard

On a phone or tablet

Everything works on a phone. Tap the **menu button** (three lines, top left) to open the menu; tap outside it or the × to close it. Tables can be swiped sideways.



Dashboard on a phone



The menu on a phone

Account and security

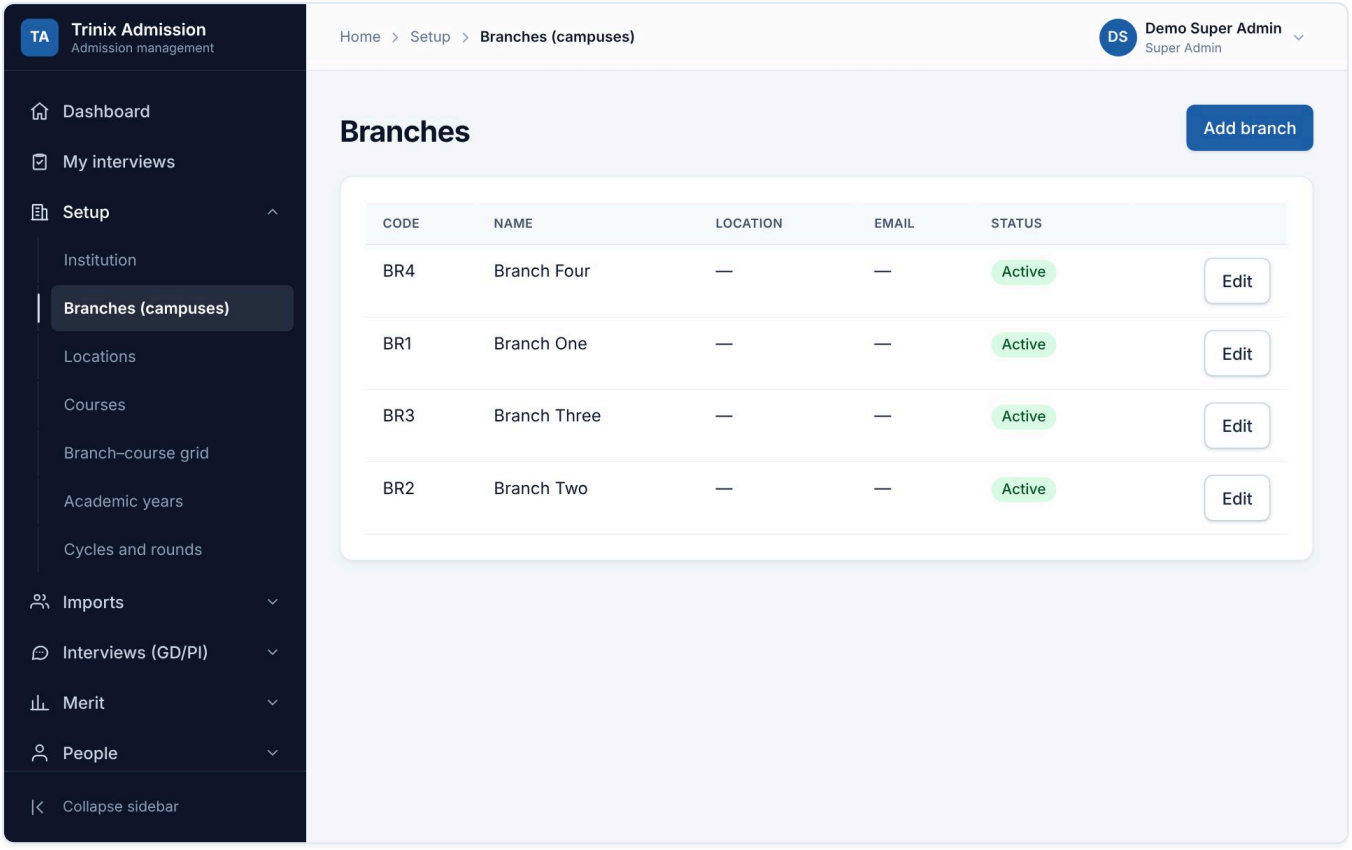
Account shows your roles and lets you change your password, turn two-factor sign-in on or off (where your role allows it), and see new recovery codes. You are signed out automatically after a period of inactivity.

Setup

Setup is done once, by a Super Admin or Central Admission Administrator, and updated each year. Do it in this order.

Institution, branches (campuses) and locations

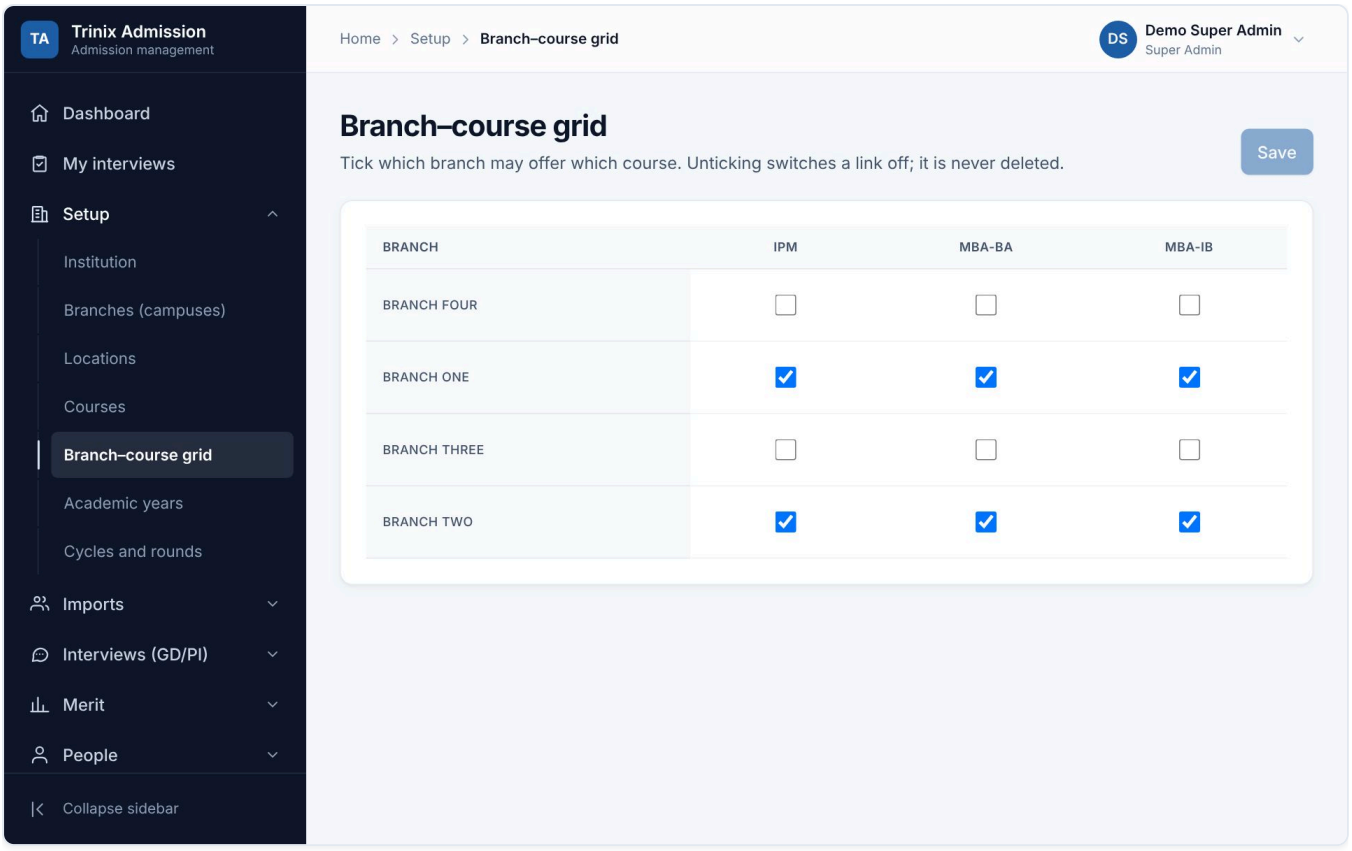
- **Institution**: the institute's name and details, used in emails.
- **Branches (campuses)**: one record per campus, e.g. Delhi, Kolkata, Kakinada, GIFT City. The **code** (e.g. DEL, KOL) is what portal files use for campus preferences, so choose it carefully. It cannot change once in use.
- **Locations**: addresses where things happen, for example campuses and interview centres in other cities. GD/PI panels are held at a location (or online).



Branches (campuses)

Courses and the branch–course grid

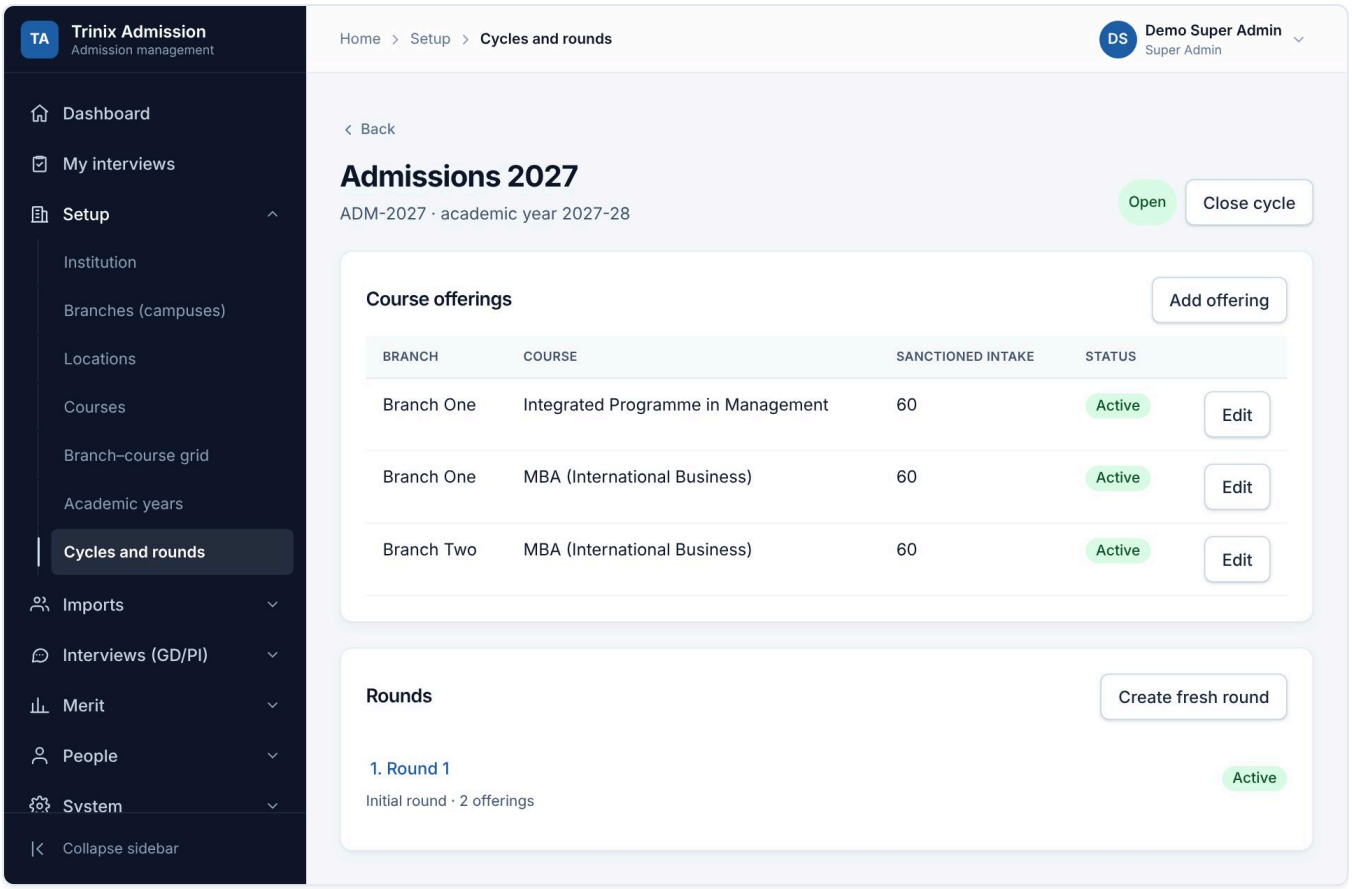
Courses lists each programme (e.g. MBA-IB, MBA-BA, IPM) with its level, duration and entrance exam (CAT or IPMAT). The **Branch–course grid** says which campus offers which course: tick the boxes and save.



Which campus offers which course

Academic years and admission cycles

1. **Academic years**: add the year, e.g. **2027-28** with its start and end dates.
2. **Cycles and rounds** → **Add cycle**: the admission cycle for that year, e.g. *Admissions 2027*.
3. Open the cycle and use **Add offering** for each campus and course it admits to, with the **sanctioned intake (seats)**, e.g. MBA (IB) Delhi 240.
4. Click **Open cycle** when it is ready.



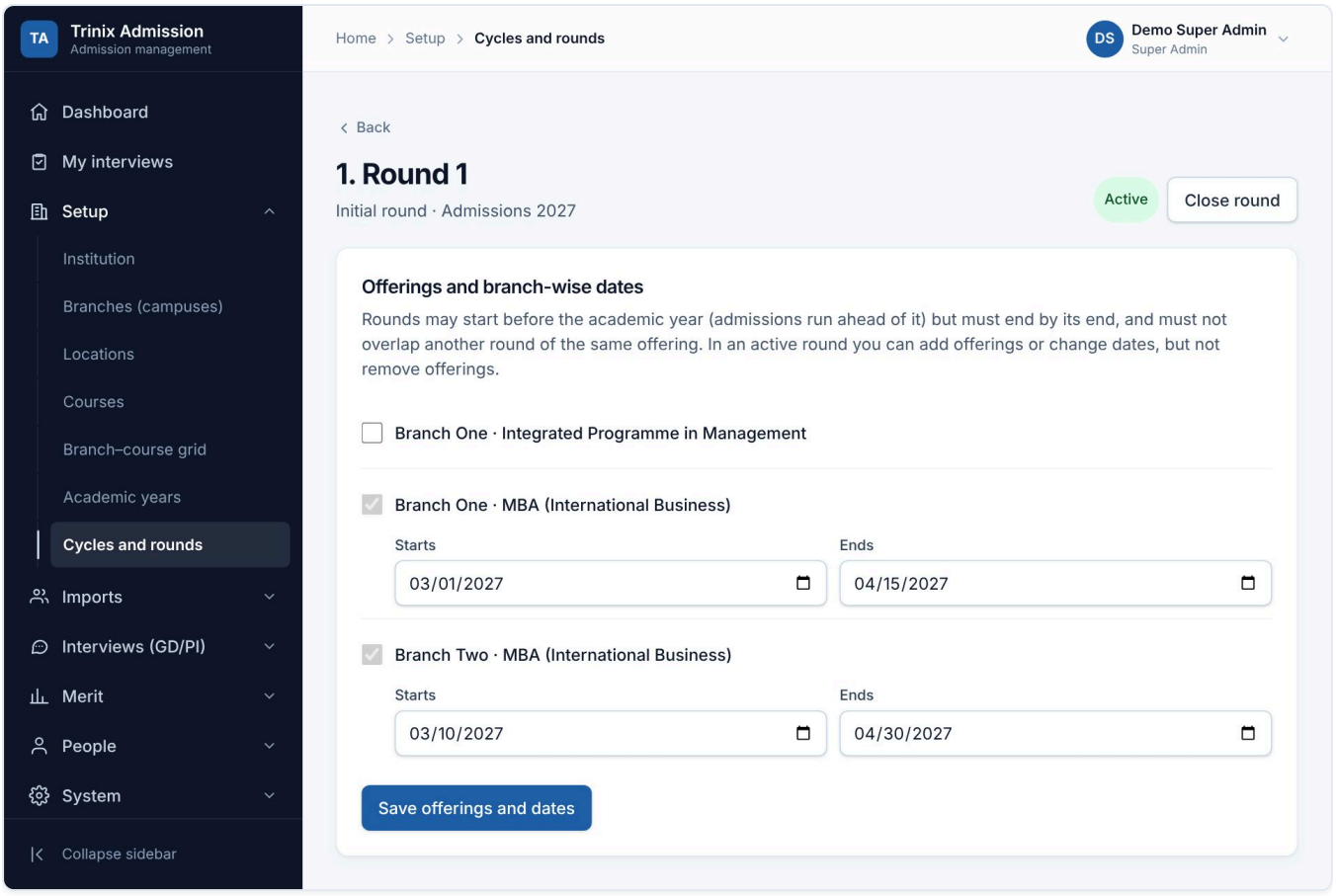
A cycle with its offerings (seats) and rounds

Rounds and campus-wise dates

Applicants are imported **round by round** (Round 1, Round 2, ...). In the cycle, click **Create first round** (later: **Add round**), then on the round page:

1. Tick each campus and course in the round and give its **start and end dates**. Dates can differ by campus.
2. Click **Save offerings and dates**, then **Activate**.
3. When the round is over, click **Close round** and give a reason. A closed round is read-only; **Reopen** needs a reason and is recorded.

> Rounds may **start before** the academic year, because admissions run ahead of it (e.g. from December 2026 for 2027-28), but must **end by** the year's end. Two rounds of the same campus and course cannot overlap.

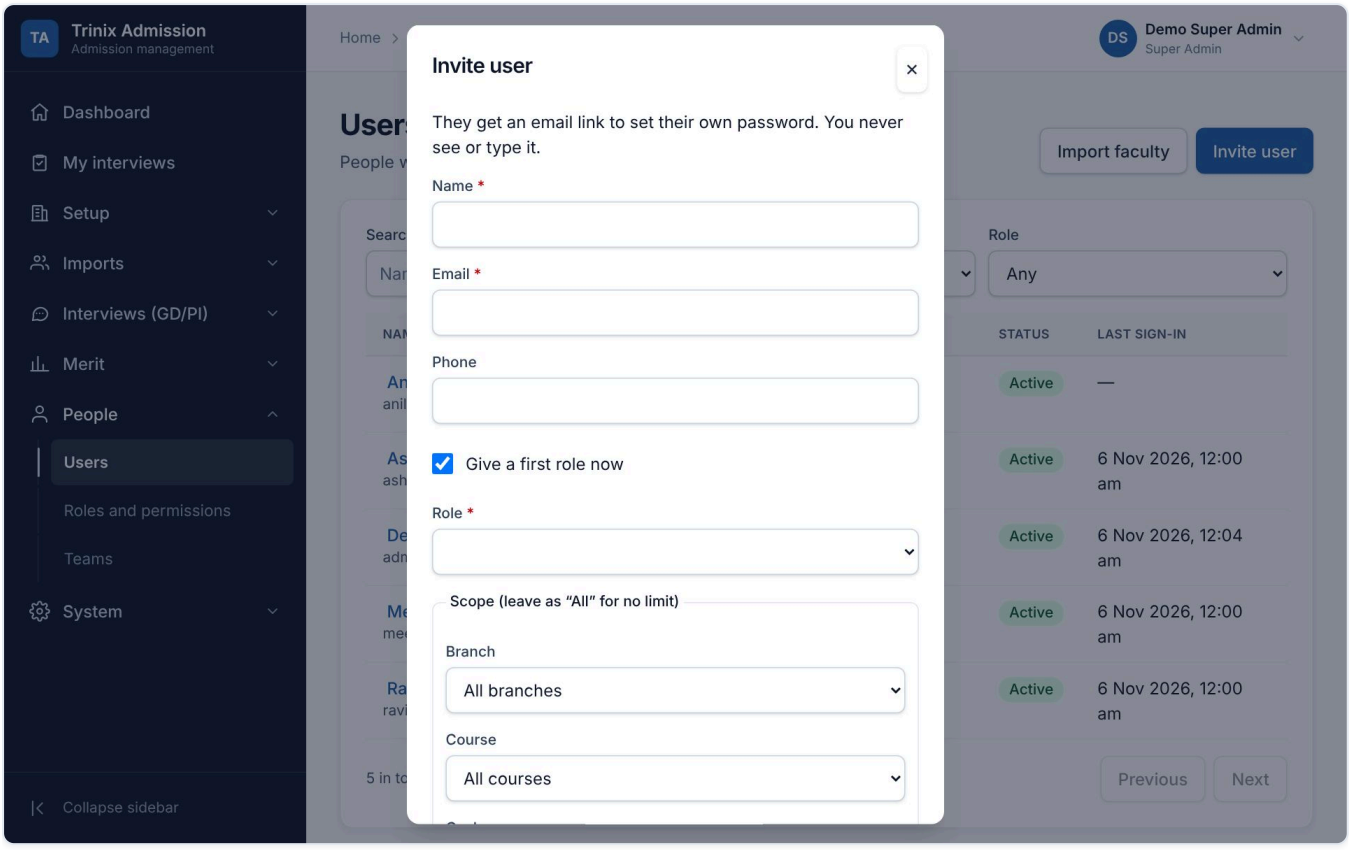


Campus-wise dates of a round

People

Users and invitations

Users lists everyone who can sign in. **Invite user** creates an account and emails an invitation. Give each person a **role** and, if needed, a **scope**: a campus, a course and/or a cycle. Leave a box empty for "all".



Inviting a user with a role and scope

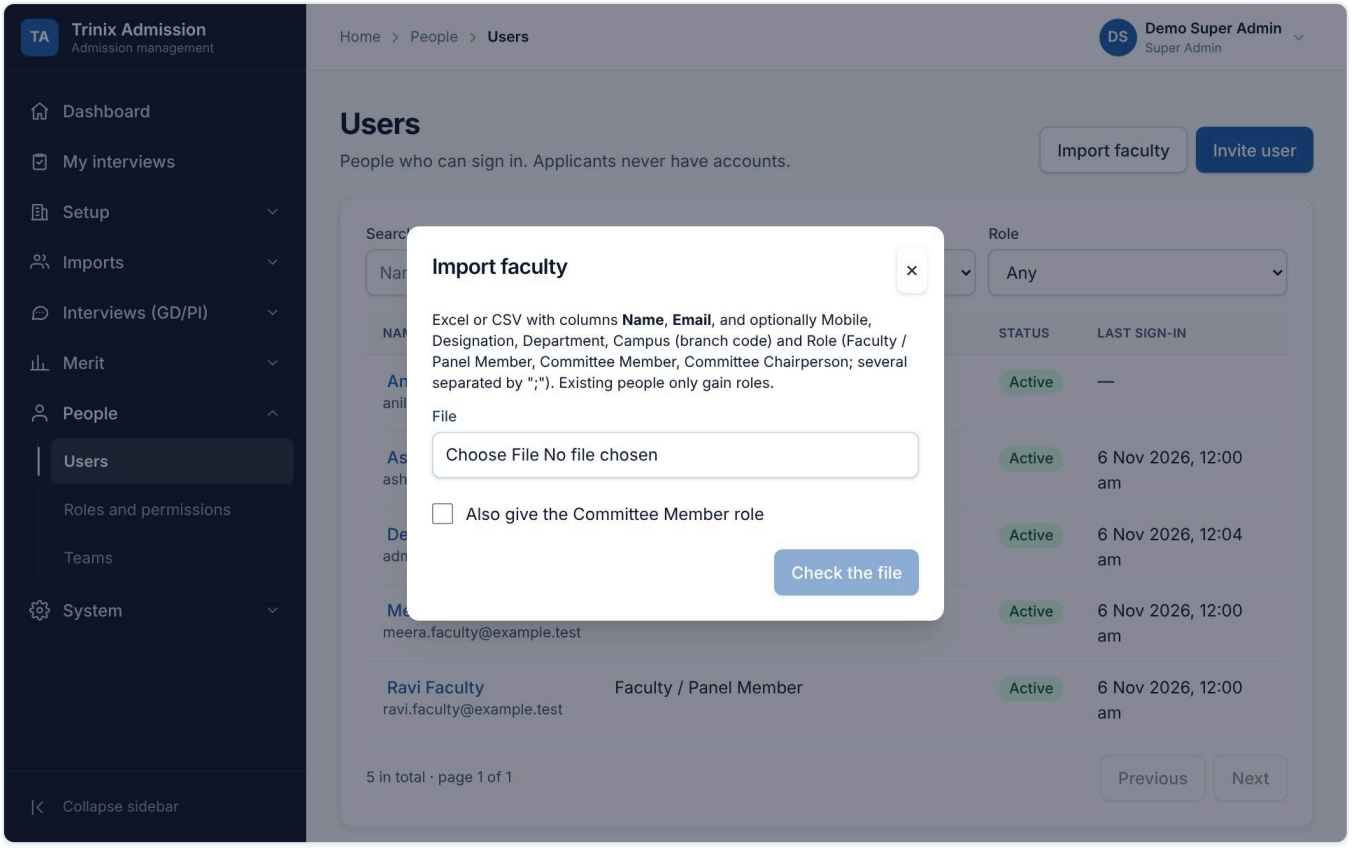
- A person can hold several roles. Open the user and use **Add role**.
- Roles are removed (revoked) with a reason; the history is kept.
- Nobody can give a role or scope wider than their own, or change their own roles.
- **Suspend** stops someone signing in, with a reason; **Reactivate** restores access.

Importing faculty and panel members

To add many faculty at once, use **Users** → **Import faculty**:

1. Prepare an Excel or CSV file with the columns **Name** and **Email**, and optionally **Mobile**, **Designation**, **Department**, **Campus** (branch code, e.g. DEL) and **Role**: Faculty / Panel Member, Committee Member or Committee Chairperson, with several separated by ";".
2. Choose the file. Tick **Also give the Committee Member role** if panel members are also committee members.

3. Click **Check the file**. Each row shows whether the person is new, existing (gets the roles) or unchanged, or has an error such as a bad email, an unknown campus or a duplicate.
4. Click **Confirm and send invitations**. New people get an invitation email. Existing people only gain roles; nothing is ever removed.



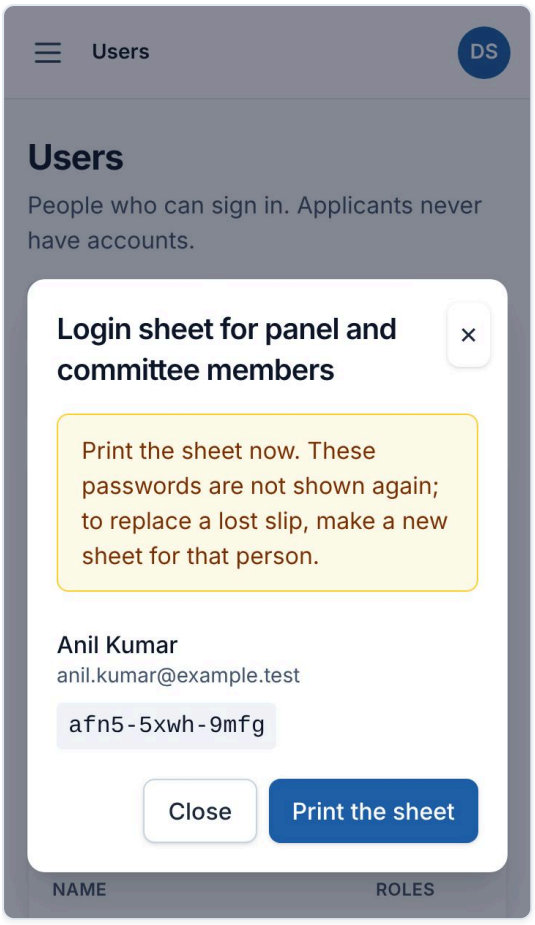
Import faculty

Login sheet for panel and committee members

Instead of email links, panel and committee members can be given a printed slip with their sign-in details. **Users** → **Login sheet**:

1. Tick the people (by default, everyone who has never signed in). Search by name, email or role.
2. Click **Make passwords for …**. Each person gets a new temporary password, such as `k7mq-3hxp-9tbw` (no look-alike letters). Their old password and any invitation link stop working.
3. Click **Print the sheet**: one slip per person with the website, their email and the password. **The passwords are not shown again**; for a lost slip, make a new sheet for that person.
4. At first sign-in the person must choose their own password before anything else opens.

Administrators (roles that need two-factor sign-in) are not offered a sheet: they use invitation links. Every sheet is recorded in the audit log, never with the passwords.



The passwords, shown once, ready to print

Roles and permissions, teams

Roles and permissions shows what each role may do (see Chapter 10). Only the Super Admin can change a role's permissions. **Teams** holds committees and admission cells, with their members and history.

Applicants and imports

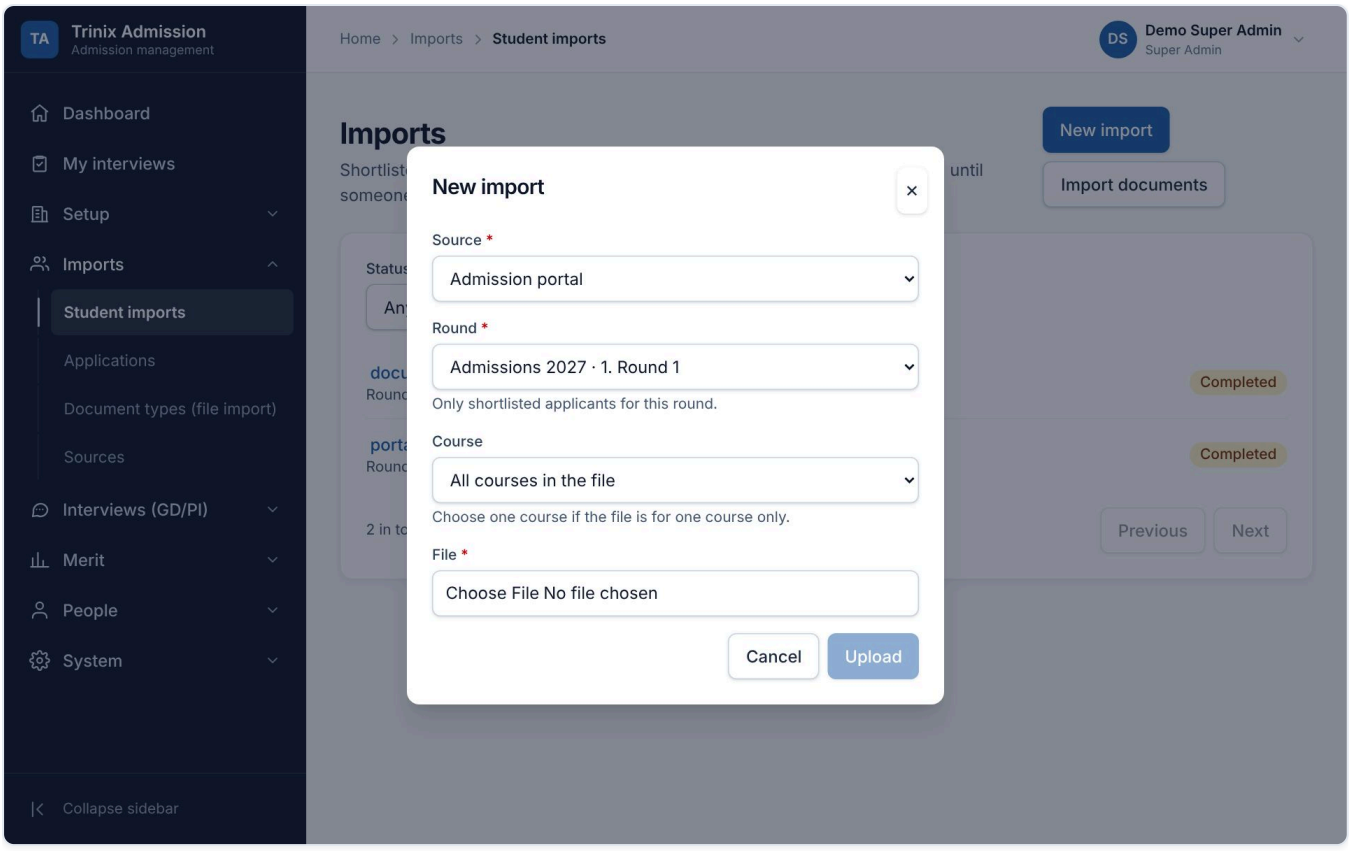
Sources

A **source** is where applicant data comes from, normally the *Admission portal*. In **Sources** (Super Admin), add the source and, if the portal will send data through the API, create a **source token**. It is shown once only; give it to the portal's technical team.

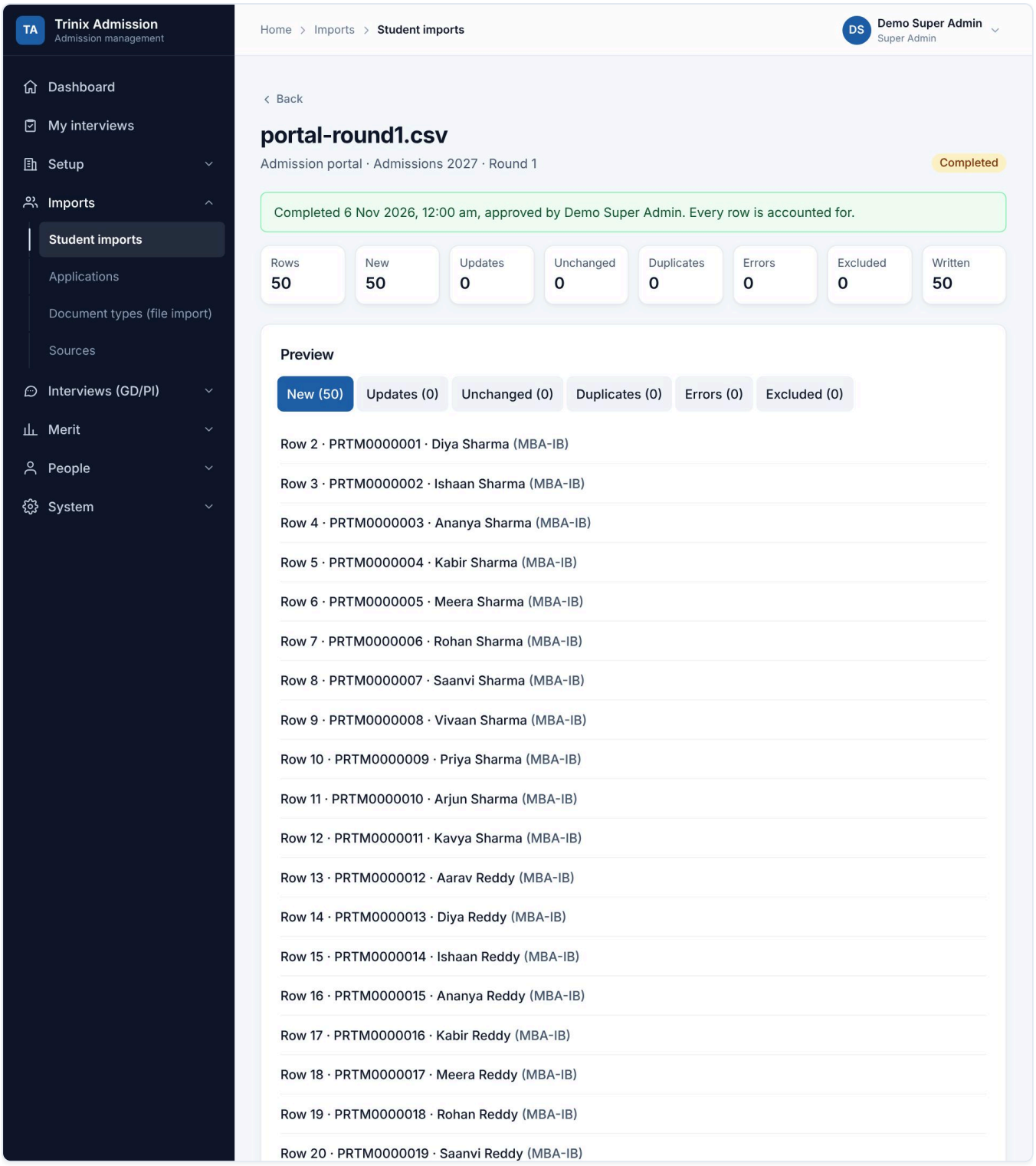
Importing a portal file

Only the **shortlisted applicants of a round** are imported. Every import goes through the same checks, and nothing reaches the applicant records until a second person approves it.

1. **Imports** → **New import**: choose the source, the **round**, the course (or "All courses in the file"), and the Excel/CSV file. Click **Upload**.
2. **Match the columns**: for each field (application number, name, CAT number, percentile, category, marks, campus preferences, GD/PI centre preferences, ...) pick the column in the file. Add **value translations** where the portal uses different words, e.g. "General" → GEN or "OBC" → OBC-NCL. **Save as template** so next time it is filled in for you.
3. Click **Check the rows**. The batch shows **New**, **Updates** (changes to applicants already imported), **Unchanged**, **Duplicates** and **Errors**, row by row. You can exclude rows, with a reason.
4. A **different person** with approval rights opens the batch and clicks **Approve and write**. The batch then says "Every row is accounted for".



Starting a new import for a round

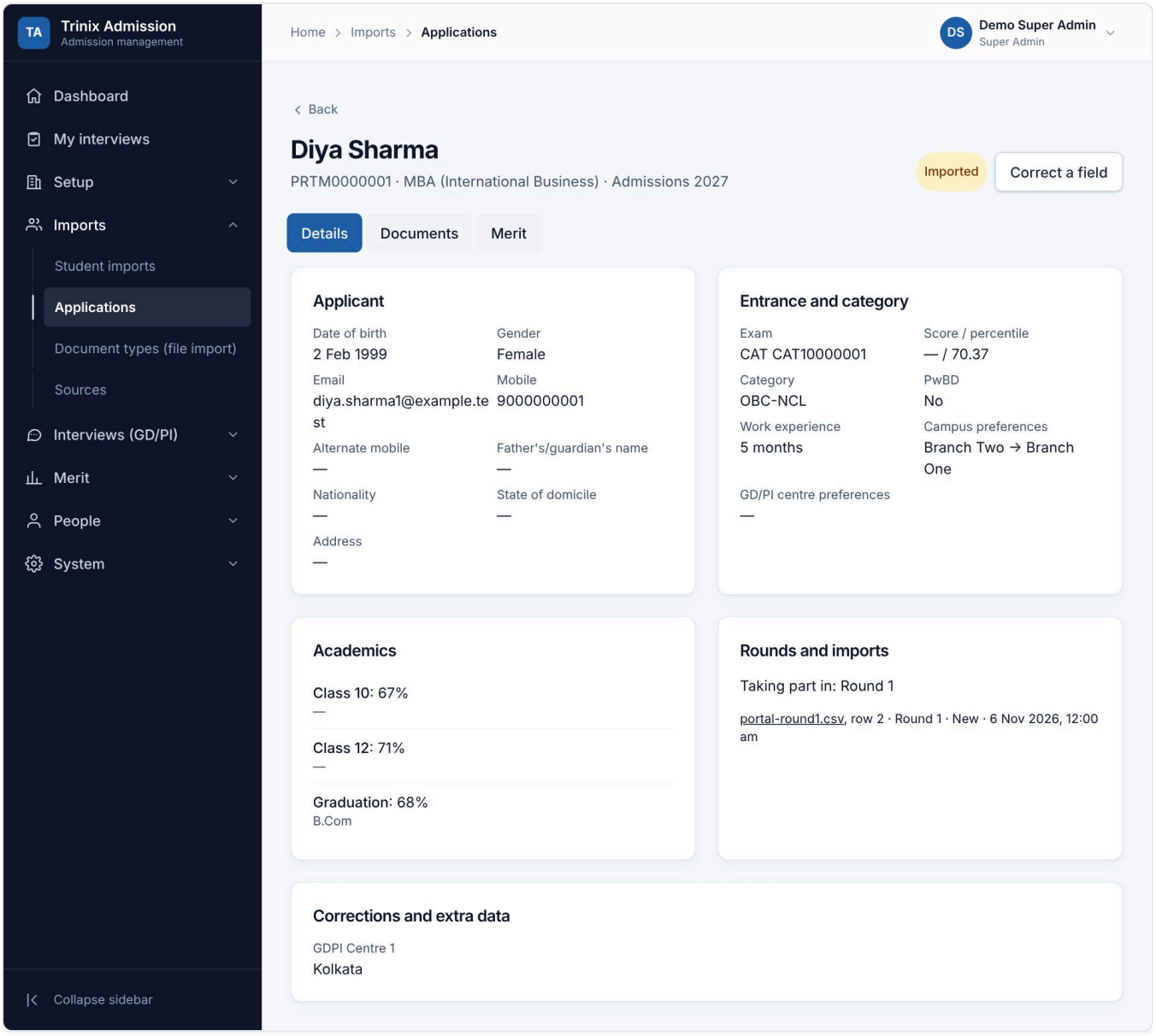


An import batch: counts and the preview of every row

> **Duplicates and updates.** An applicant is identified by *source + portal application number + course + cycle*. A later round's file adds new applicants and shows changes to existing ones as updates. Everyone imported into a round is a GD/PI candidate of that round. Empty cells never erase stored data. A student who applied to two MBA courses has two application numbers and two separate records.

Applications

Applications lists applicants in your scope. Search by application number, CAT/IPMAT number or name, and filter by course, round or status. Open an application to see its tabs:



An application: details tab

Tab	What it holds
Details	Personal and contact details, entrance scores, academics, campus preferences, GD/PI centre preferences, rounds, status history, corrections
Documents	Files imported or uploaded (optional), with versions and scan status
Merit	The applicant's place in published merit lists (Chapter 8)

Applicants' files (optional)

If the portal gives applicants' documents, first load the document types under **Imports** → **Document types** (**Load the suggested types**, then edit). Then **Imports** → **Import documents**: upload a ZIP

whose file names start with the application number and end with the type code, e.g. `PRTM0000001_CLASS10.pdf`. The import is previewed and approved like a data import. Every file is checked and virus-scanned, and opens only through a short signed link, which is recorded.

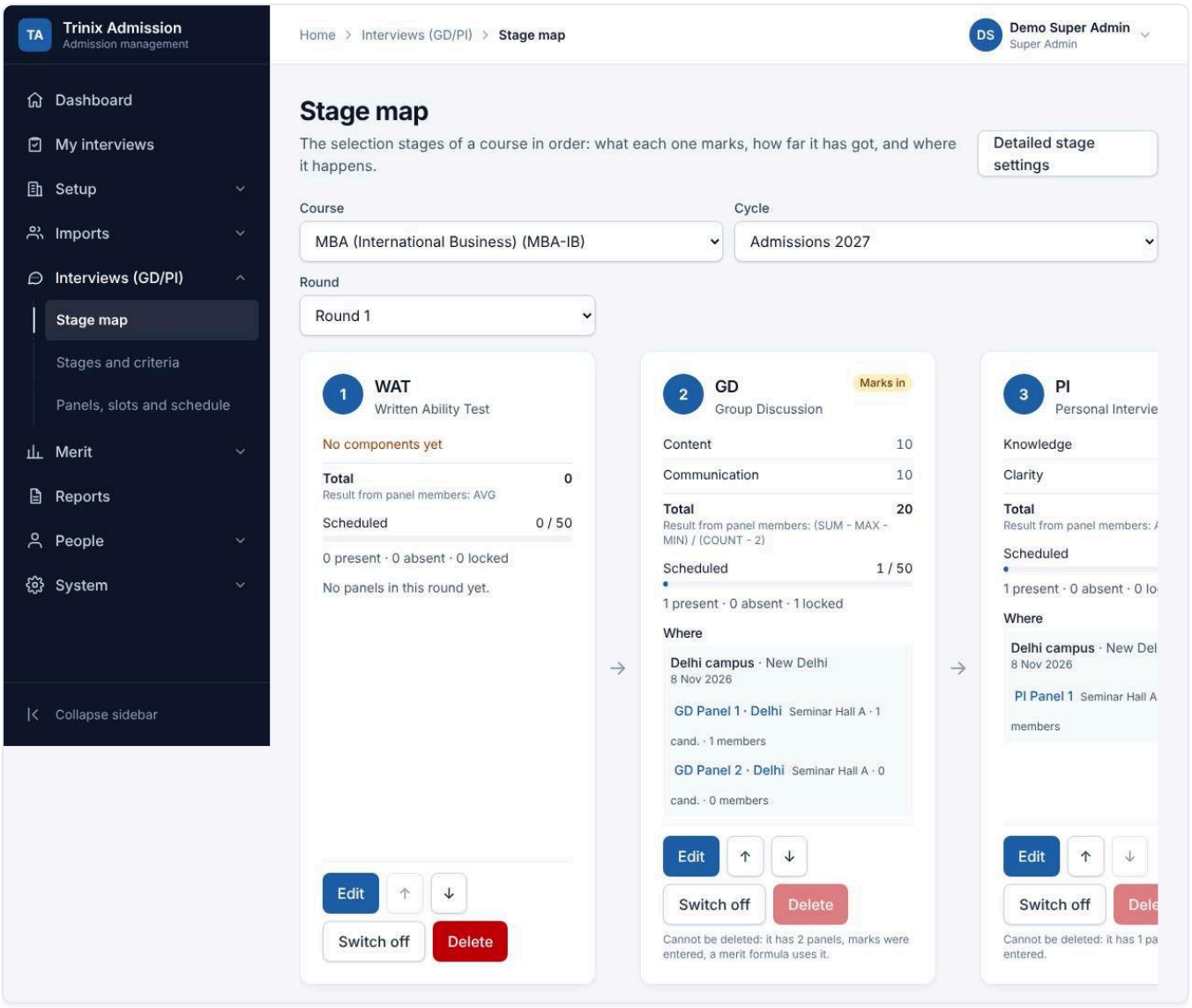
Correct a field changes a value with a **reason**; the old and new values are kept. If the same CAT number appears on another application you can see, a note shows it (the records are never merged).

Interviews (GD/PI)

Stage map

Interviews (GD/PI) → **Stage map** shows the stages of a course in order, for example **WAT → GD → PI → Merit**. Choose the course, cycle and round. Each stage box shows:

- its **components** (criteria) with their maximum marks, the **total**, and how the panel members' marks are combined;
- for the round: how many candidates are **scheduled**, present, absent and locked;
- **where** it happens: each venue (or online) with its dates and panels, with the number of candidates and members. A warning appears if a later in-person stage has panels at a place where the earlier stage was not held.

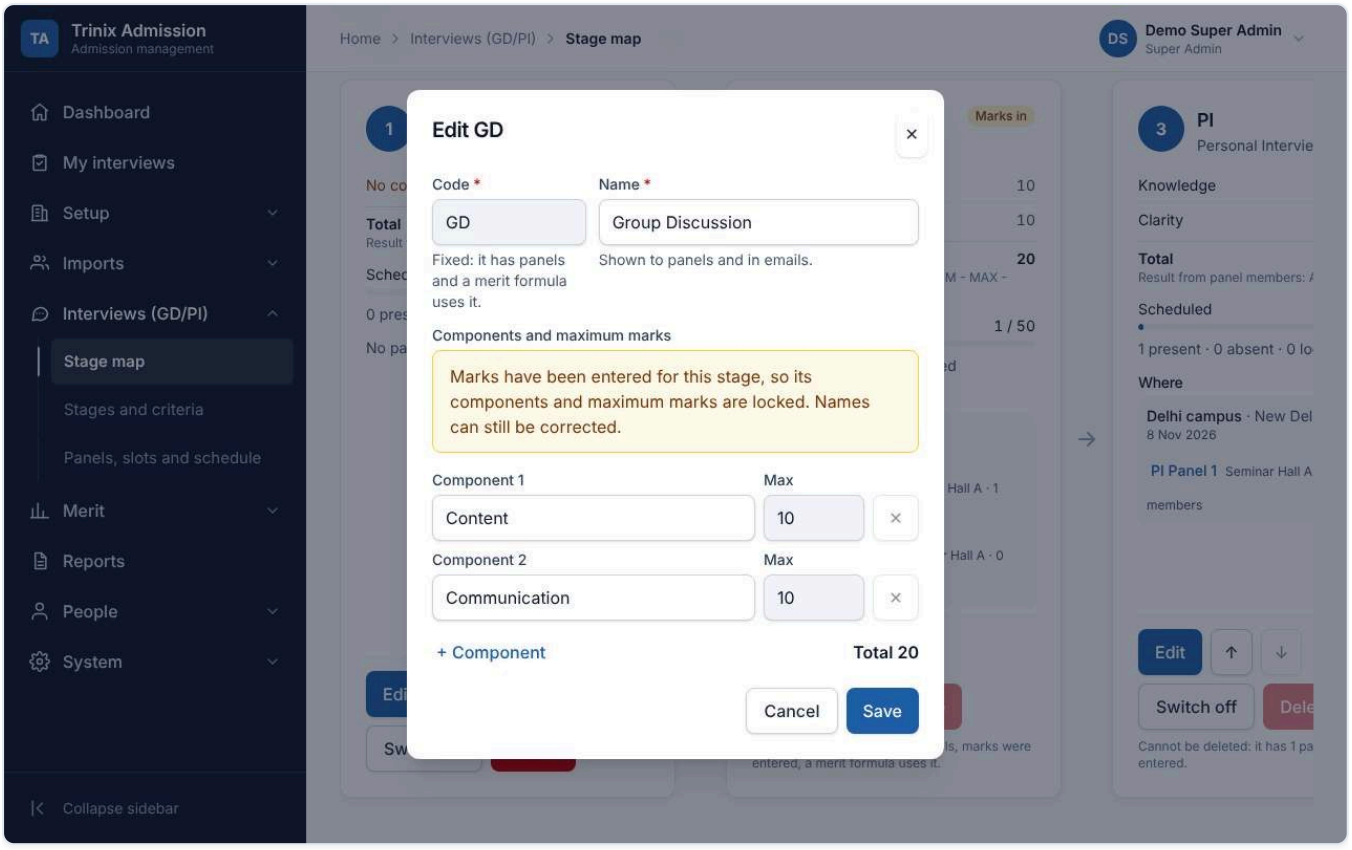


Stage map: WAT (no components yet), GD and PI with their venues and panels

The admin can change the stages here:

- **Add a stage**: a code (capitals, e.g. ESSAY), a name, and its components with maximum marks.
- **Edit**: rename the stage, change its code, and add, rename or remove components and change maximum marks.
- ↑ ↓ move a stage earlier or later. **Switch off** hides a stage this course does not use.
- **Delete** removes a stage and its components for good.

> **What locks, and when.** Until marks are entered, everything can change. Once any marks are entered for a stage, its components and maximum marks are locked (component names can still be corrected), so no marks are ever lost. The **code** is fixed once the stage has panels or a merit formula uses it. A stage can be **deleted** only while it has no panels, candidates or marks and no merit formula uses it; otherwise switch it off. The box shows the reason when something is locked, and every change is in the audit log.



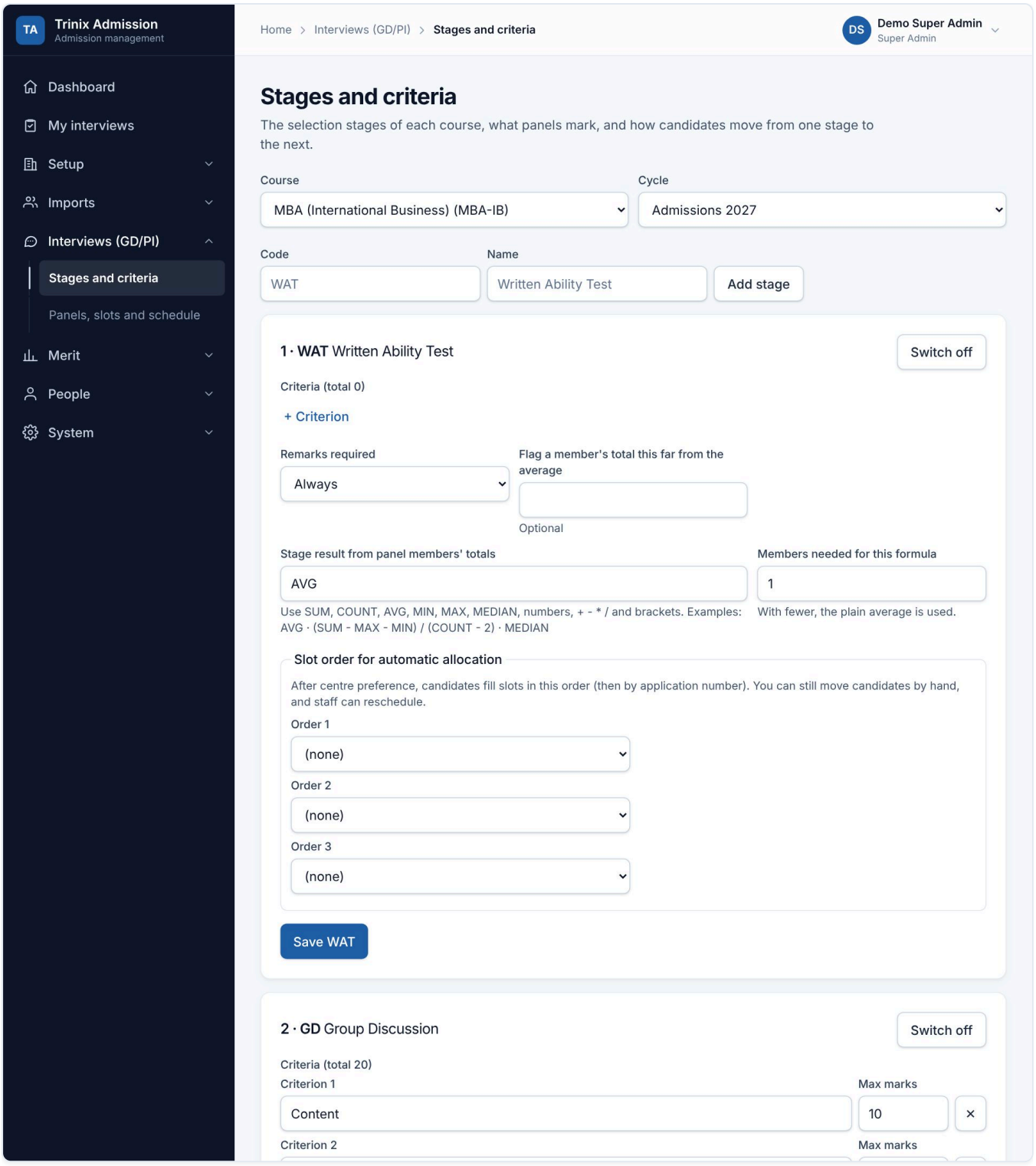
Editing GD after marks were entered: the code and maximum marks are locked, with the reasons

Stages and criteria (each cycle)

Stages and criteria (choose the course and cycle) defines the selection stages, e.g. **WAT, GD, PI** for MBA and **WAT, PI** for IPM. For each stage the admin sets:

- **Criteria and maximum marks**, e.g. Content 10 and Communication 10. These are set for every cycle; **Copy stages and criteria** brings last cycle's set in to edit. Once marks are entered, the criteria can no longer change.
- **Remarks required**: always, never, or only when the total is below a value.

- **Stage result from panel members' totals**: the formula combining the members' marks. Use `AVG` (average), `MEDIAN`, or a formula such as `(SUM - MAX - MIN) / (COUNT - 2)`, which drops the highest and lowest marks. **Members needed for this formula**: with fewer members marking, the plain average is used. The formula cannot change once any result in the stage is locked.
- **Flag a member's total this far from the average** (optional): highlights unusual marks.
- **Switch off** a stage the course does not use this cycle (for example WAT, if it is not held). A switched-off stage takes no new panels and is left out of the schedule template, automatic allocation and the workflow. **Switch on** brings it back.
- For a later stage (e.g. PI): **Panel sees marks from earlier stages**, and **Minimum GD average to be sent here** (optional).



Stages, criteria and settings

The interview schedule from Excel

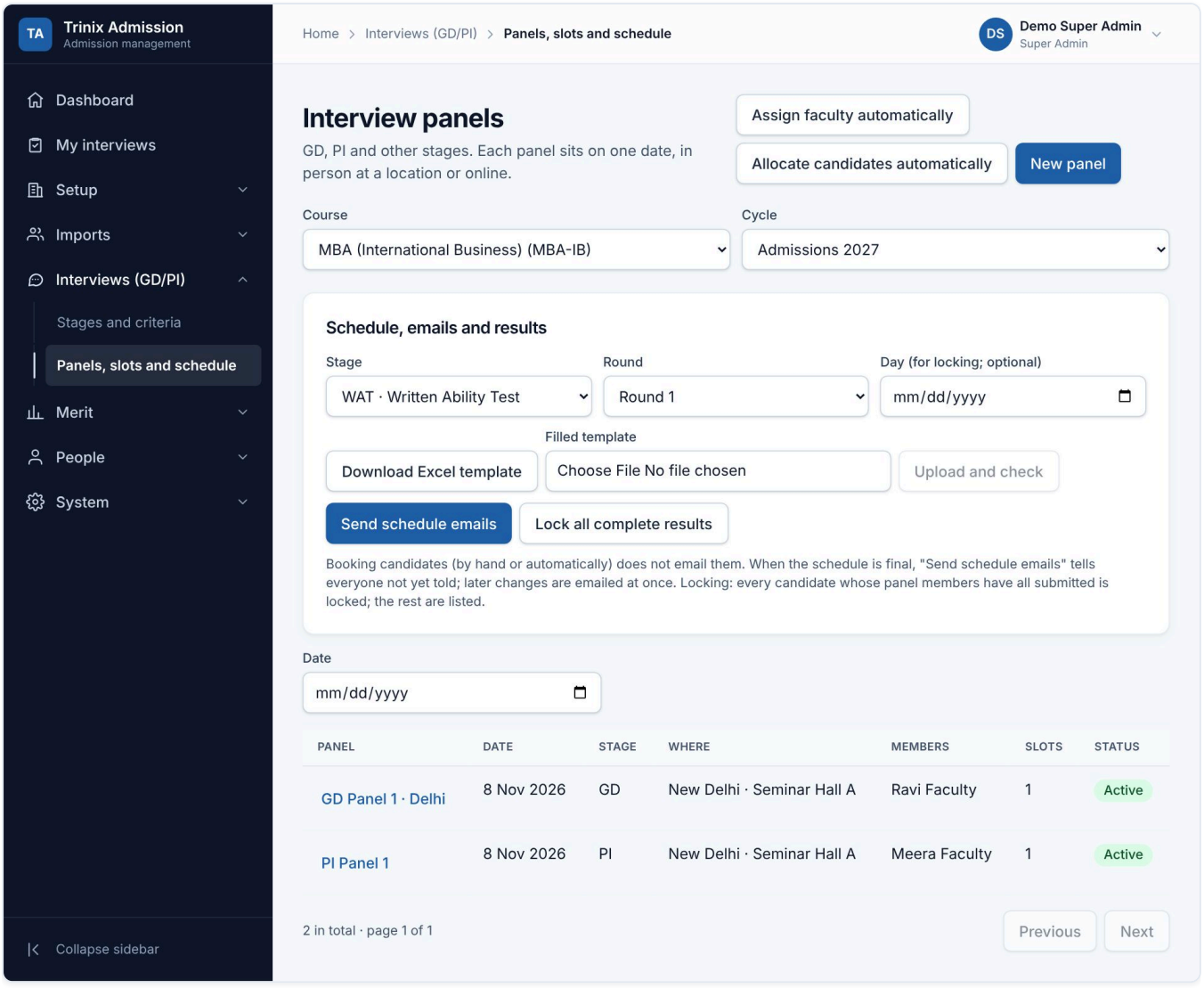
Everyone imported into a round is a candidate; there are no call lists. Plan the interviews in Excel:

1. **Panels, slots and schedule** → choose the course and cycle → **Download Excel template**.
2. Fill **one row per slot**:
   - stage (GD or PI), panel name, date (DD-MM-YYYY), mode (In person or Online);

- for in person: the venue (a location code or name from Setup → Locations), optionally the city and room;
- for online: the meeting link;
- slot start and end (e.g. 10:00 and 10:45), and candidates per slot;
- panel members' emails, separated by `;`.

Rows with the same stage, panel and date make one panel.

3. Choose the round, pick the filled file and click **Upload and check**. Every problem is listed by row: an unknown stage, venue or member, times out of order, overlapping slots, or a member on two panels at the same time. Fix the file and upload it again.
4. When there are no problems, check the preview and click **Save the schedule**. Everything is saved at once, or nothing. A panel that already exists (same name, stage and date) gets the new slots and members.

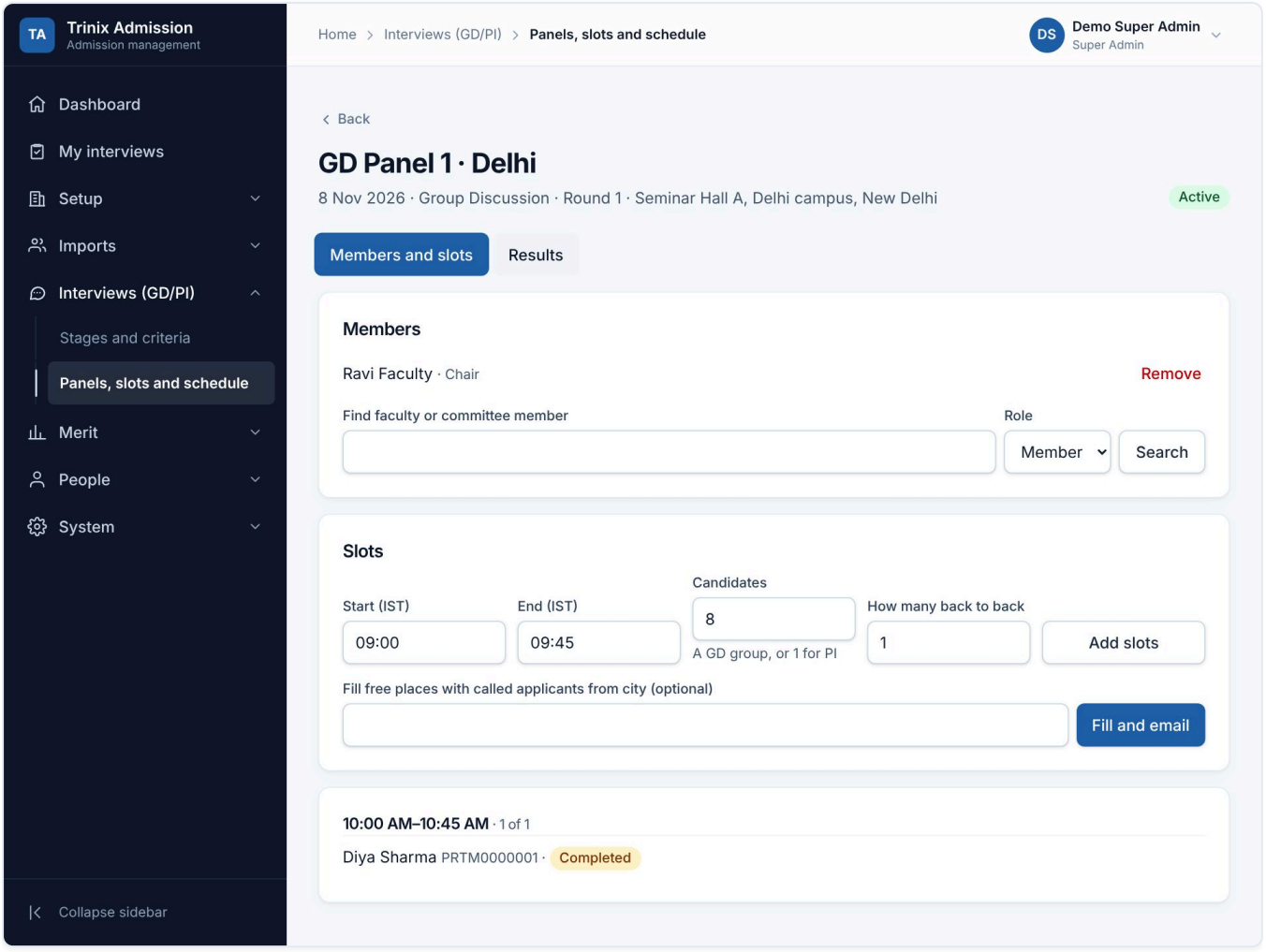


Panels, slots and schedule: the Excel template, schedule emails and locking

Interview panels

Interview panels → **New panel**: the stage, round, name, date, and **in person** (location and room, in any city) or **online** (meeting link). On the panel page:

- **Members**: search for faculty or committee members and add them. A chair is optional.
- **Slots**: start and end time (IST) and how many candidates. Use 8–10 for a GD group, or 1 for a PI. **How many back to back** makes a series of slots at once.
- **Schedule an applicant** books one applicant of the round into a slot. **Fill** fills the free places, optionally only with applicants from one city.



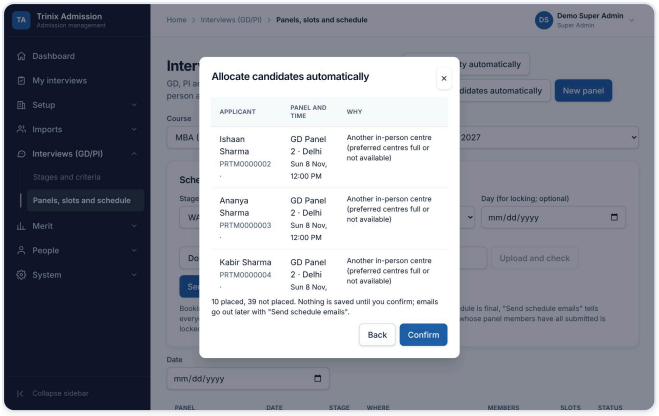
A GD panel: members, slots and candidates

Automatic allocation, with changes by hand

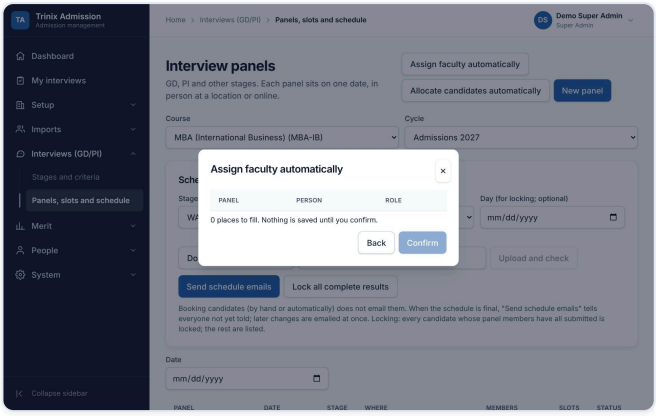
On **Interview panels**, two buttons do the allocation for a whole stage. Both show a **preview**, and nothing is saved until you confirm.

- **Allocate candidates automatically**: applicants of the round not yet scheduled for the stage are spread over the stage's panels. The order is the applicant's **GD/PI centre preference** 1, 2, 3, then their **city**, then any other in-person centre, then online. Everyone who can get their first choice is placed before anyone gets a second choice, and panels are filled evenly. For PI, only applicants whose GD result is locked are placed, in a slot after their GD. **After an in-person GD, the PI is at the same venue**, on a panel without the GD panel's members where possible.

- **Slot order:** in **Stages and criteria**, each stage has up to three keys (name, gender, date of birth, application number, each ascending or descending) that decide the order in which candidates fill the slots after their centre preference.
- **Different panel for PI:** if a PI panel has a member who already marked the candidate in GD, a warning names them. Booking a PI at another venue than an in-person GD is refused.
- **Assign faculty automatically**: fills panels with the number of members you choose from the people who can mark, optionally only from one campus. Work is spread evenly and nobody is on two panels at the same time.



Allocate candidates automatically



Assign faculty automatically

Changes by hand on the panel page: **Move** a candidate to another slot, **Swap** two candidates (on any panels of the same stage), or **Cancel**. Each needs a reason; applicants who were already sent their schedule are emailed the new time. A **reminder email** goes to every applicant the day before their interview.

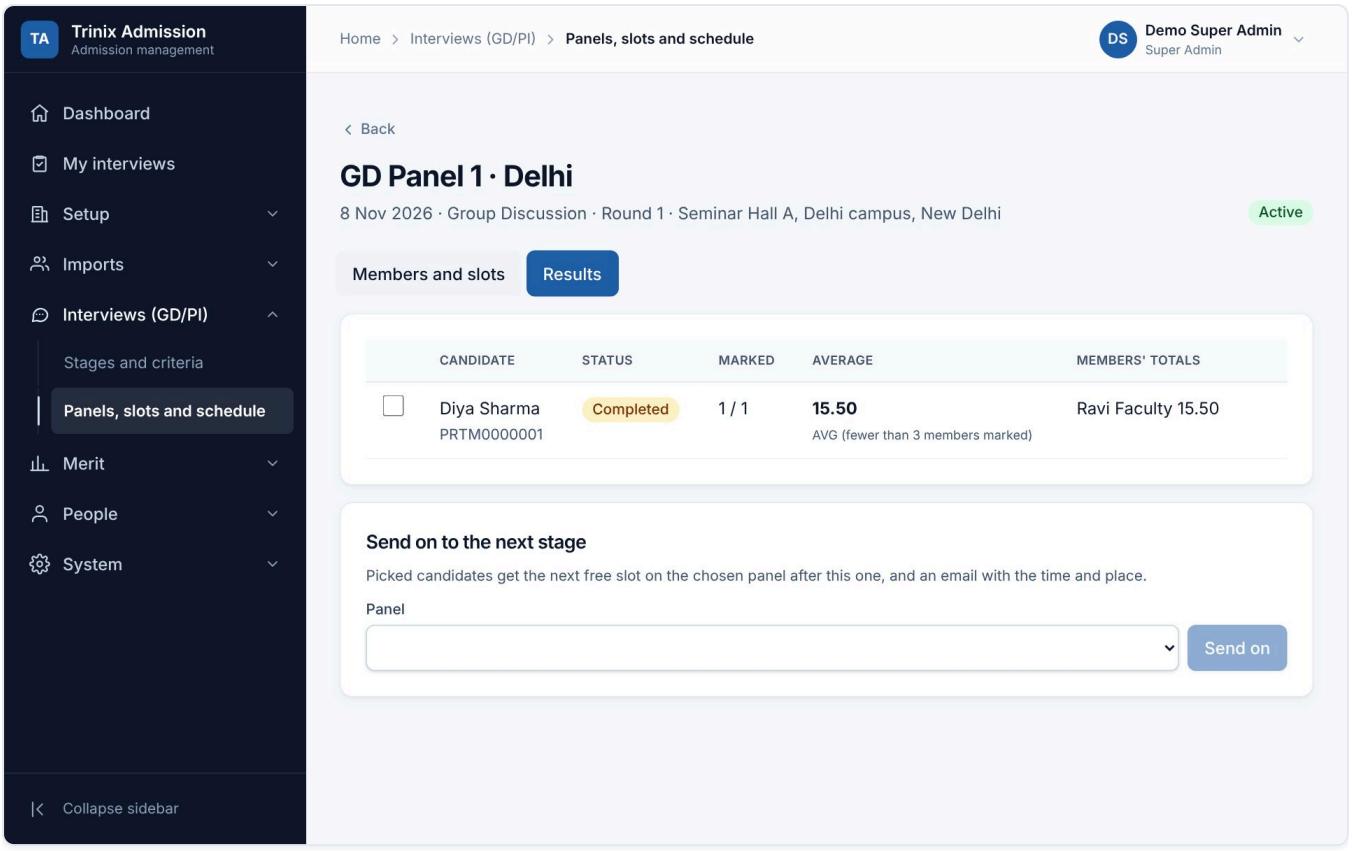
Fix the schedule, then send the emails

Booking candidates, by hand or automatically, does **not** email them, so you can change the schedule freely. When it is final, choose the stage and round under **Schedule, emails and results** and click **Send schedule emails**: everyone booked and not yet told gets their date, time and venue (or meeting link). Candidates not yet emailed show "not emailed yet" on the panel page.

> The system refuses clashes: an applicant in two overlapping slots or twice in a stage, a full slot, a member on two panels at once, or a member who has declared a **conflict of interest** with the applicant.

Results and sending candidates on to PI

The panel's **Results** tab shows each candidate's marks from every member, the stage result and any unusual marks. When everyone has submitted, the **admin** locks the result: **Lock** for one candidate, or **Lock all complete results** on the Panels page for a whole stage (optionally one day). Candidates whose marks are not complete are listed and stay open. Locked GD candidates can be **sent on** to a PI panel: tick them, choose the panel (at the same venue for in-person GDs), and each gets the next free slot after their GD.

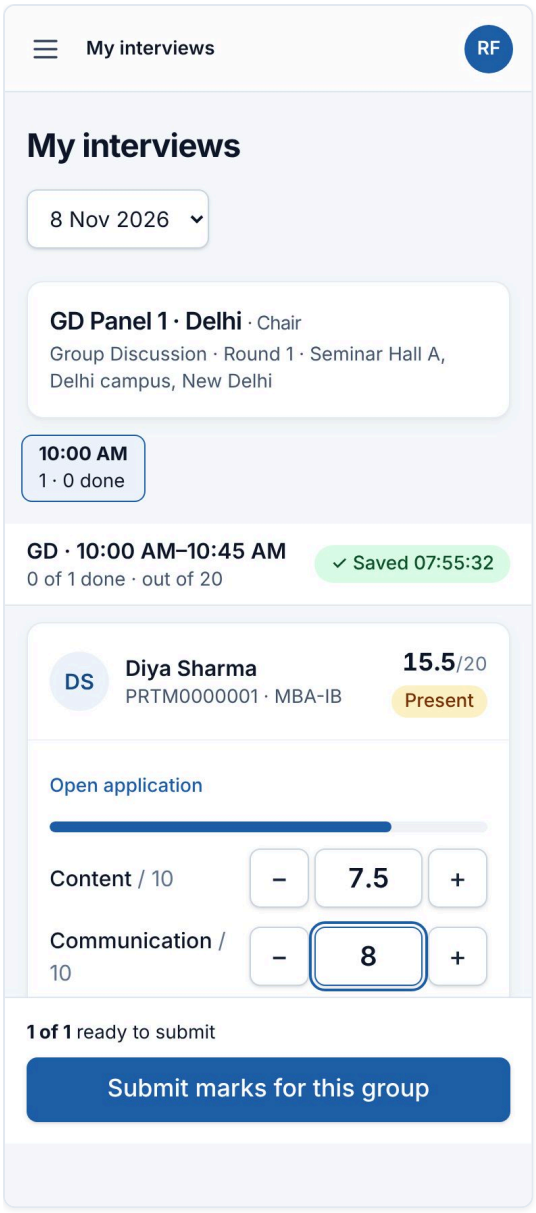


Panel results and sending on to PI

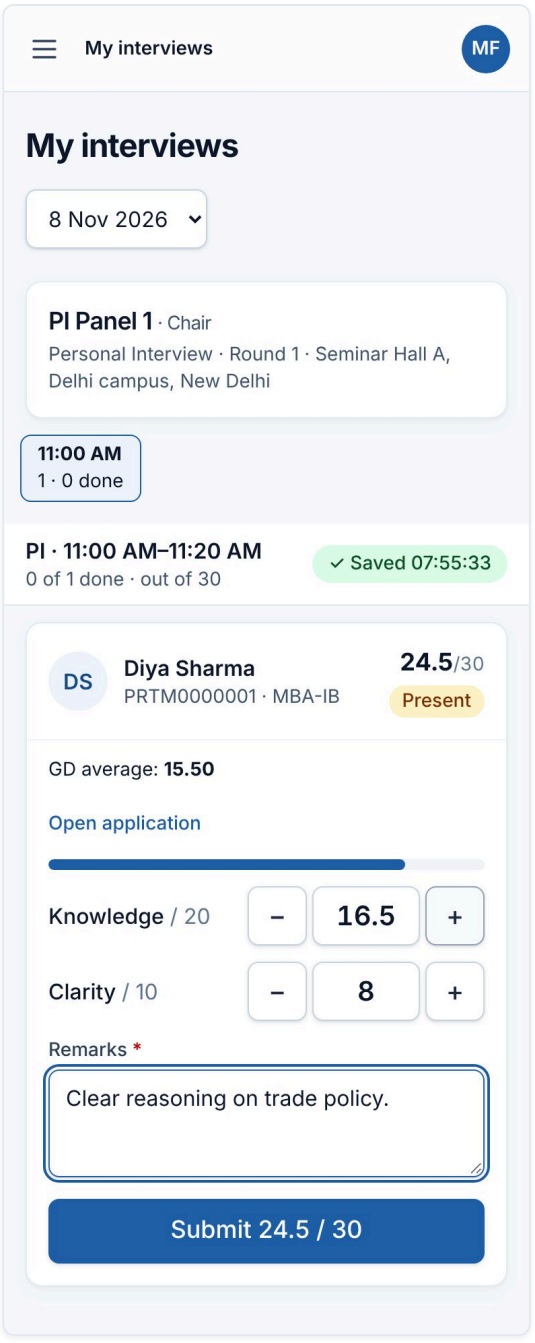
Marking interviews

Panel members mark on their own **phone or tablet** during the GD or PI. An internet connection is needed; marks are saved as you type.

1. Sign in and open **My interviews**. Choose the **date** if it is not today.
2. Your panel, venue (or meeting link) and the **time slots** are shown. Tap a slot.
3. When a candidate arrives, tap **Present** (or **Absent**) on their card. On a panel without a chair, any member can do this.
4. Enter the marks for each criterion: type them, or use − and + (steps of 0.5). The **total** and a bar at the top of the card update as you go. A mark above the maximum turns red and is not saved until corrected. The bar at the top of the screen shows "✓ Saved" when your marks are stored, and how many candidates of the slot are done.
5. Add **remarks** where the stage requires them.
6. Tap **Submit** (PI; the button shows the total) or **Submit marks for this group** (GD). Submitted and absent candidates fold into one line; tap a line to open it again. You cannot change submitted marks; the admin locks the results when every member has submitted.



A GD slot on a phone



A PI slot, showing the GD result

- You see **other members' marks only after you submit your own**.
- Made a mistake after submitting? The admin can **reopen** your marks, with a reason; the earlier marks are kept in the history.
- If you know a candidate personally, tap **Declare a conflict of interest** before marking. You will not mark that candidate, and the office can move them.
- The **application** link opens the candidate's full application and documents, for your own candidates only. Each opening is recorded.

CHAPTER 8 · MENU: MERIT

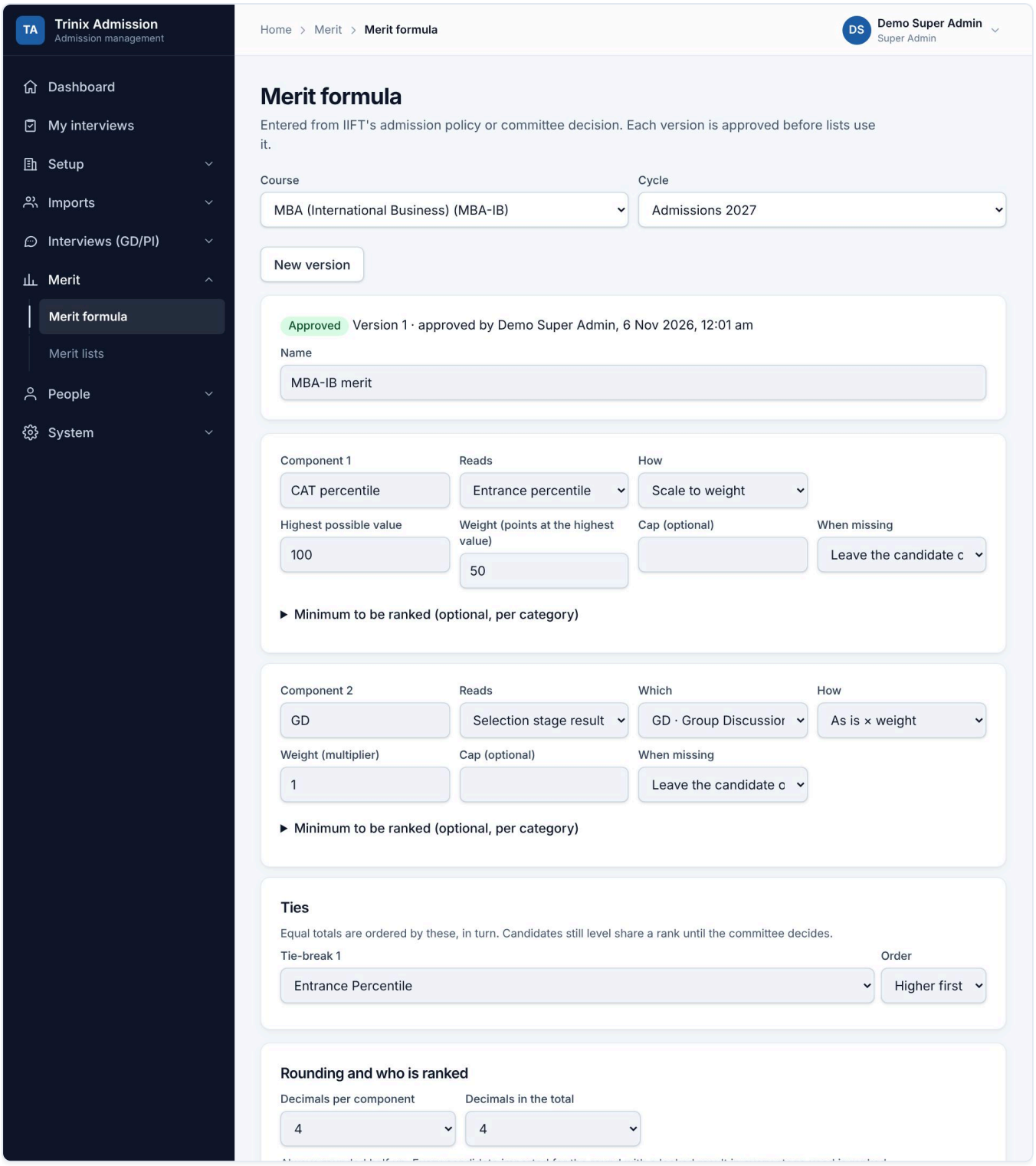
Merit

The merit formula

Merit formula (choose the course and cycle) holds IIFT's formula as a **weighted sum of components**. **Start a formula** (or **New version**), then add each component:

Setting	Meaning
Reads	The value used: entrance percentile or score, a sectional score, academic marks (%), work experience (months), a selection stage result (WAT/GD/PI), or an applicant field with a points table
How	**Scale to weight** (value ÷ highest possible value × weight), **Ranges → points** (e.g. months of experience to points), **Value → points**, or **As is × weight**
Weight, cap	Points at the highest value (or a multiplier), and an optional maximum
When missing	Leave the candidate out (with the reason), or count as zero
Minimum to be ranked	Optional, per category, e.g. a minimum PI result

Also set the **tie-break order** (e.g. higher PI result first, then higher CAT percentile, then older candidate first), the **decimals** (always rounded half up), and the **source**. **Try it on one candidate** shows the calculation for any application number before you approve. A Committee Chairperson or Central Admin clicks **Approve**.



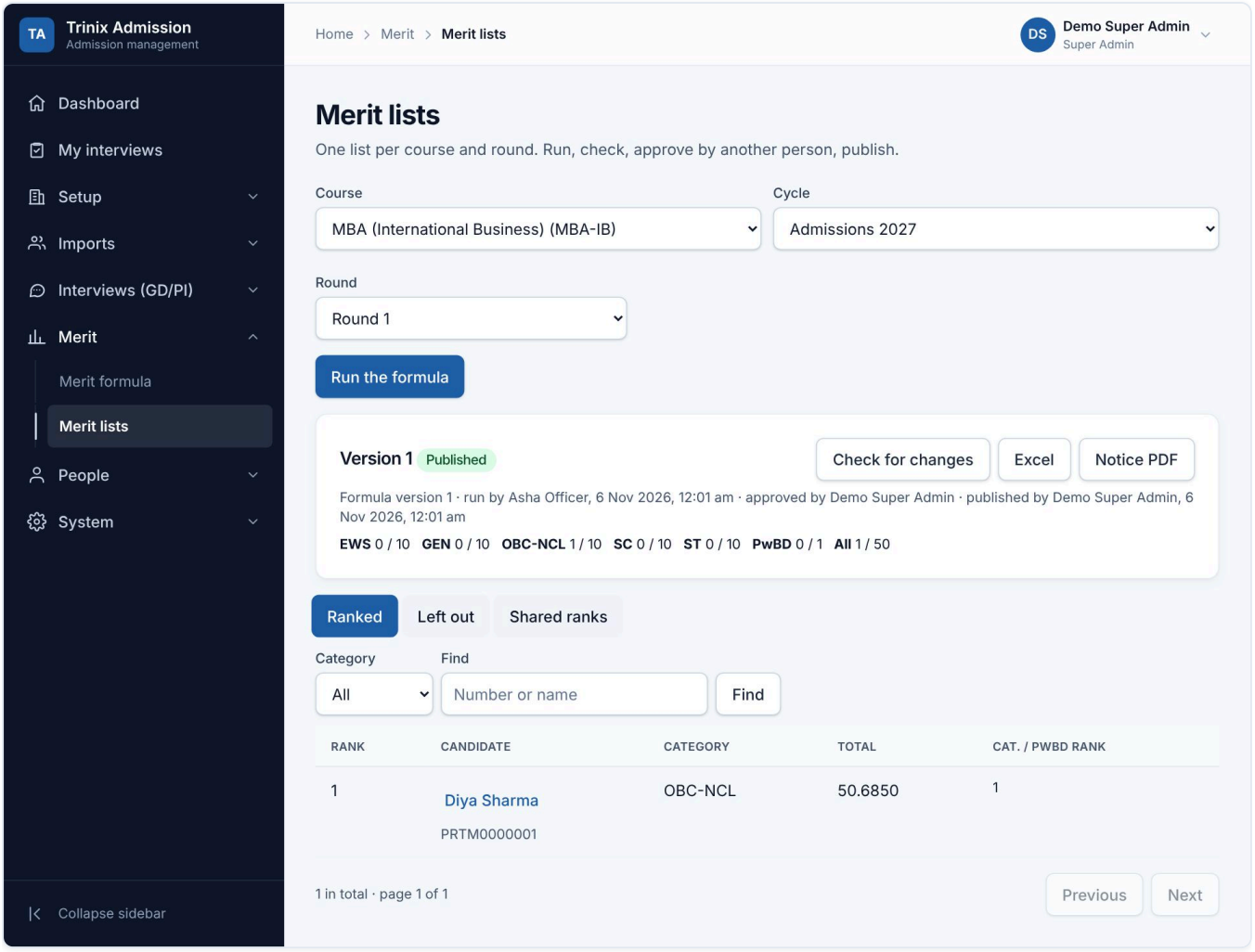
A merit formula with two components and a tie-break

> Academic marks are used as the **percentage the applicant gave**. If only a CGPA was given, the value counts as missing and the list shows "percentage not given".

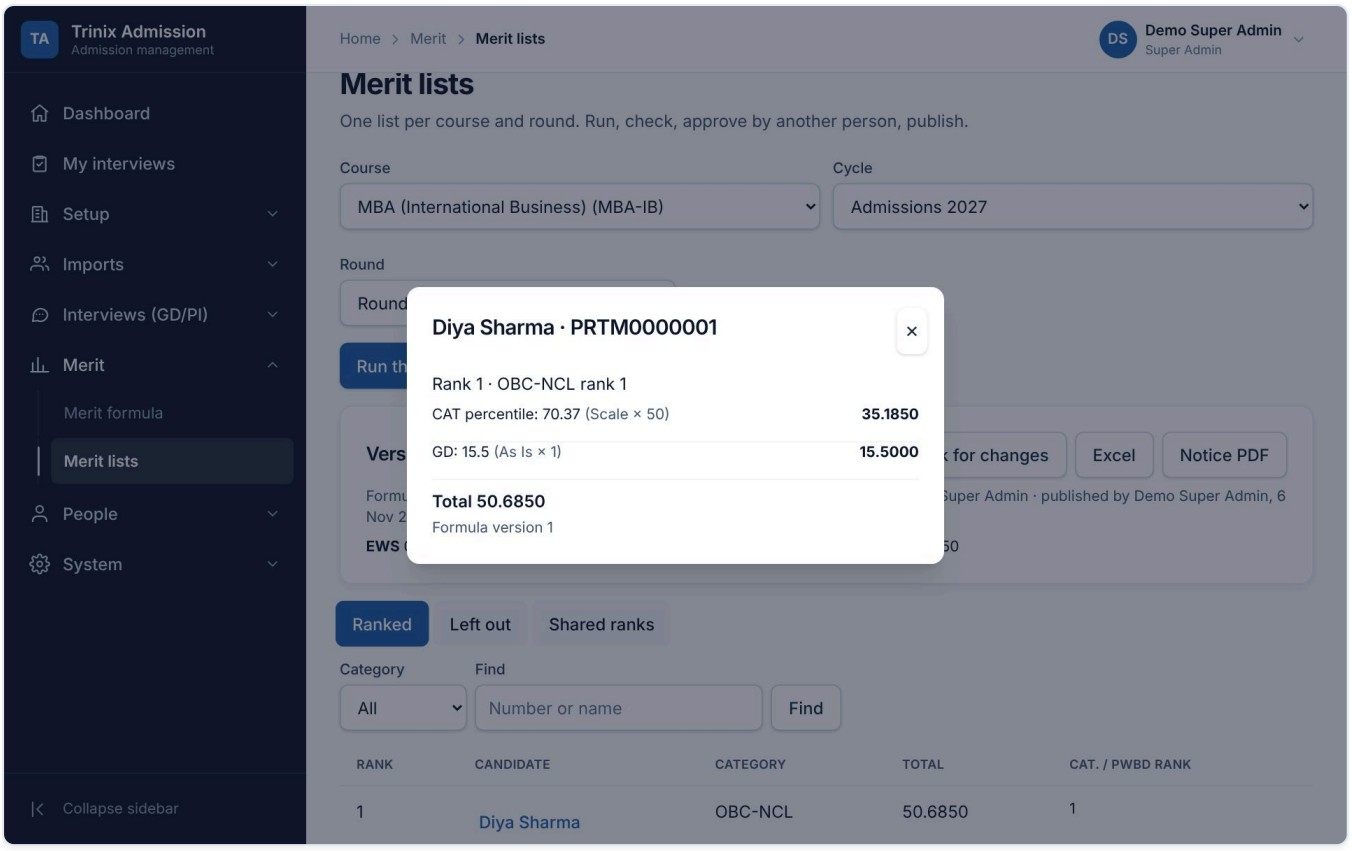
Merit lists

1. **Merit lists** → choose course, cycle and round → **Run the formula**.

2. Check the **Ranked**, **Left out** (with reasons) and **Shared ranks** tabs. Click a name for the full breakdown. Filter by category to see category ranks, or by PwBD.
3. Candidates still level after every tie-break share a rank. The committee orders them on the Shared ranks tab, with a reason.
4. A **different person** clicks **Approve**, then **Publish**. A published list is read-only.



A published merit list



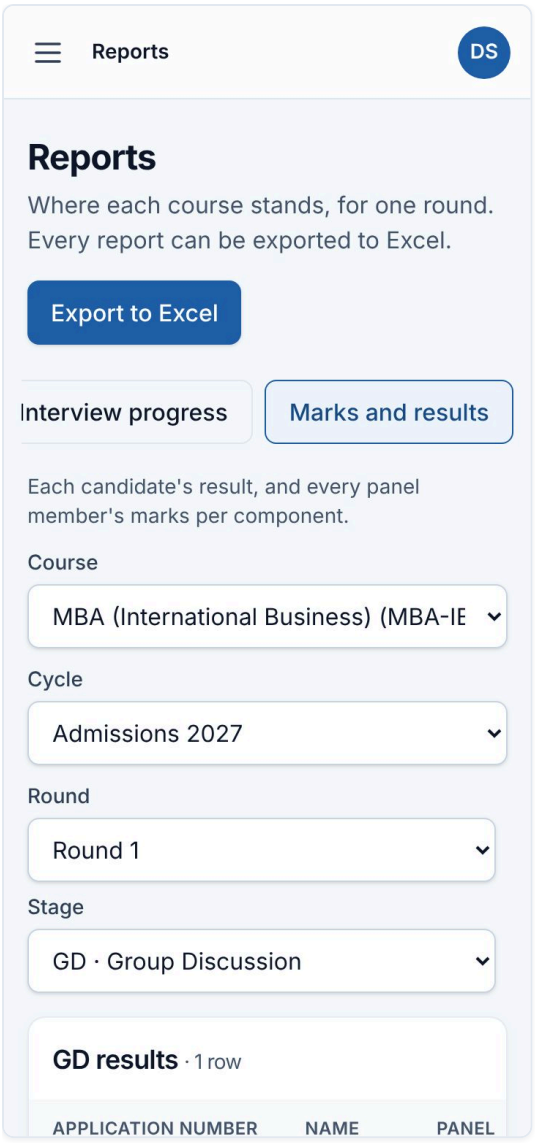
One candidate's breakdown

- **Excel** exports the full breakdown for the committee. **Notice PDF** gives a notice-board list (number, name, category, total and ranks, with no contact details). Both are recorded.
- **Check for changes** compares the list with today's data and re-calculates the stored data to confirm the result. If marks are reopened or a field is corrected after publishing, the list is marked **out of date**; run a new version, and **Compare** shows what changed.

Reports and exports

Reports (in the menu) shows four reports for one course and round. **Export to Excel** saves the report shown, one sheet per table; every export is recorded in the audit log.

- **Interview progress**: per stage and panel: scheduled, attendance not yet marked, present, absent, marks complete, locked, and not yet emailed.
- **Marks and results** (choose the stage): each candidate's stage result, how many members have submitted and whether it is locked; and every panel member's marks per component, their total, unusual marks and remarks.
- **Faculty workload**: per panel member: panels (and as chair), dates, candidates to mark, submitted, still to mark, conflicts declared. Those with most still to mark come first.
- **Imports and applicants**: applicants in the round by category, gender and first GD/PI centre preference, and the imports with who uploaded and approved them.



Marks and results on a phone

Other exports:

- **Applications** → **Export to Excel**: the applications in the current search and filters, with contact details.
- A panel's page → **Print attendance sheet**: a PDF for the venue with each slot's candidates, Present/Absent boxes and a signature column.
- **Merit lists**: Excel with the full breakdown, or the notice-board PDF.
- **Audit log** → **Export to Excel** (Chapter 9).

Reports cover a whole course, so they are for roles that work across all campuses of the course (for example the Central Admission Administrator). Exports contain personal data: keep the files safe and delete them when no longer needed.

System administration

Installation (first time)

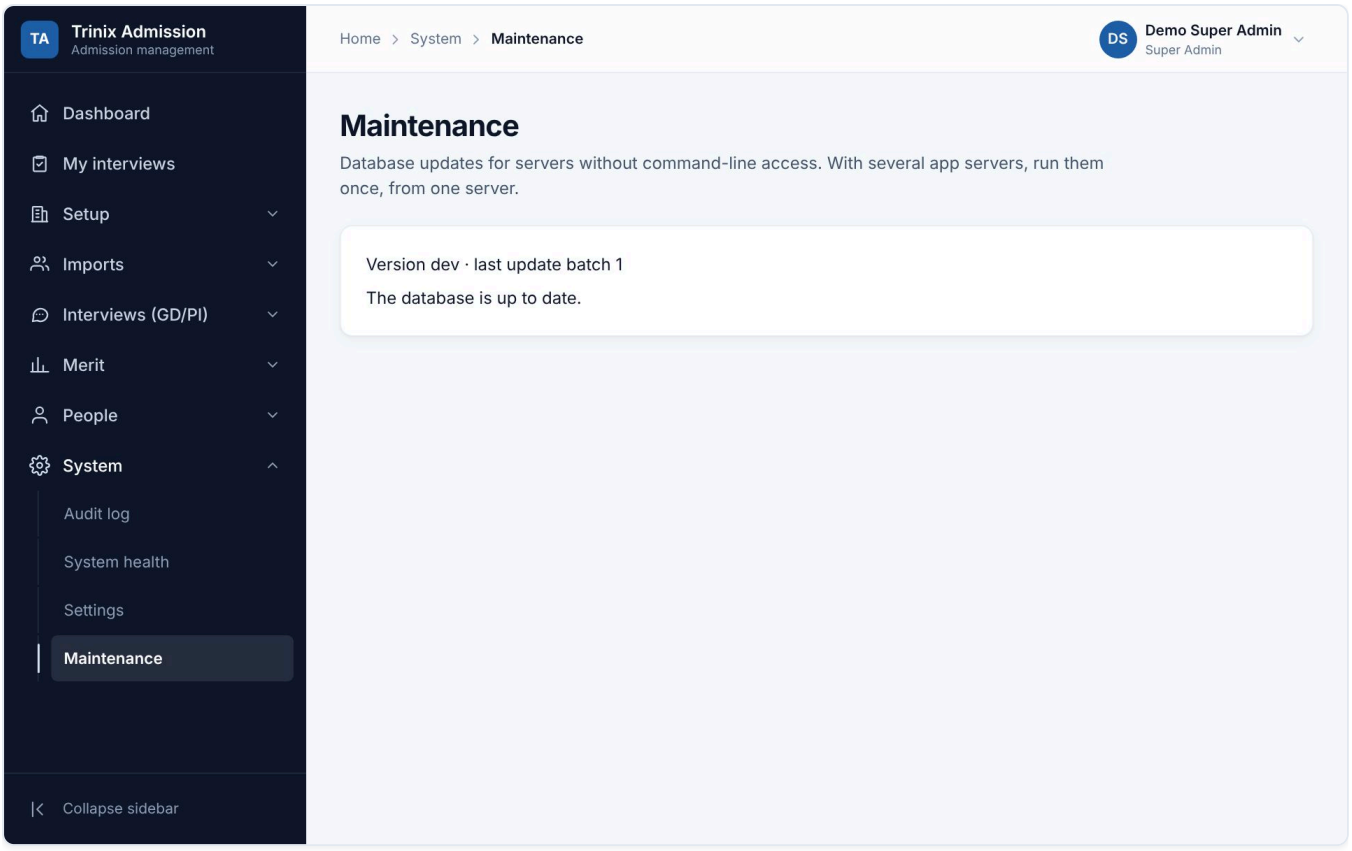
Upload the release package to the server so that the web address points at its `public` folder, then open `https://<your site>/install`. The wizard:

1. checks the server (PHP 8.3 and its extensions, writable folders; Redis and ClamAV can be added later);
2. connects to the database (MySQL 8);
3. sets the site address, time zone (Asia/Kolkata) and email server, with a **test email**;
4. sets file storage, Redis and virus scanning;
5. saves the settings, creates the tables, and creates the **first Super Admin**.

The wizard closes for good once the first Super Admin exists. The last page shows the **cron job** to add, which runs every minute. It sends reminders and, on servers without Redis, also processes imports and emails, so these do not move without it. Full steps for shared hosting are in the deployment guide that comes with the system.

Updates

Upload the new release over the old one, keeping the `.env` file and the `storage` folder. Then an IT Administrator opens **System** → **Maintenance**. If database updates are pending they are listed: **take a backup first**, type **MIGRATE** and your password, and click **Apply updates**.



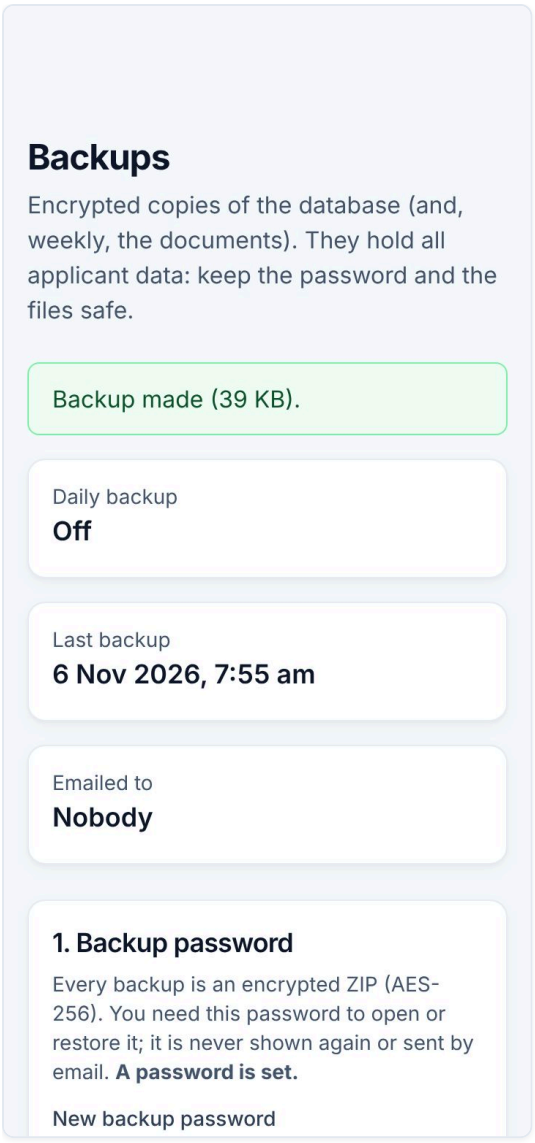
Maintenance: pending database updates

Backups

System → **Backups** (Super Admin). Backups are made by the system itself, so no command-line access is needed.

1. **Backup password** (at least 12 characters). Every backup is an encrypted ZIP (AES-256) that opens only with it. It is never shown again or emailed: keep it in a safe place. Changing it affects new backups only.
2. **Schedule and email**: tick **Make a database backup every day**, choose the time (IST), how many to keep, the day of the weekly **full backup** (database and documents), and up to three email addresses. The daily backup is emailed as the encrypted ZIP; if it is larger than the limit you set, a notice is sent instead and the file stays on the server.
3. **Back up now** makes (and emails) a database backup at once; **Full backup now** includes the documents. **Download** saves a backup to your computer; every download is recorded.

Restoring (Super Admin only): click **Restore** next to a backup, or first **Upload a backup** (for example the ZIP from an email). Type **RESTORE**, your password, and the backup password if it was different. The system first makes a **safety backup** of the current data, then replaces the database with the backup (a full backup also puts the documents back). Changes made after the backup was taken are lost; anything that went wrong can be undone by restoring the safety backup. A backup from a newer version of the system is refused: update the system first.

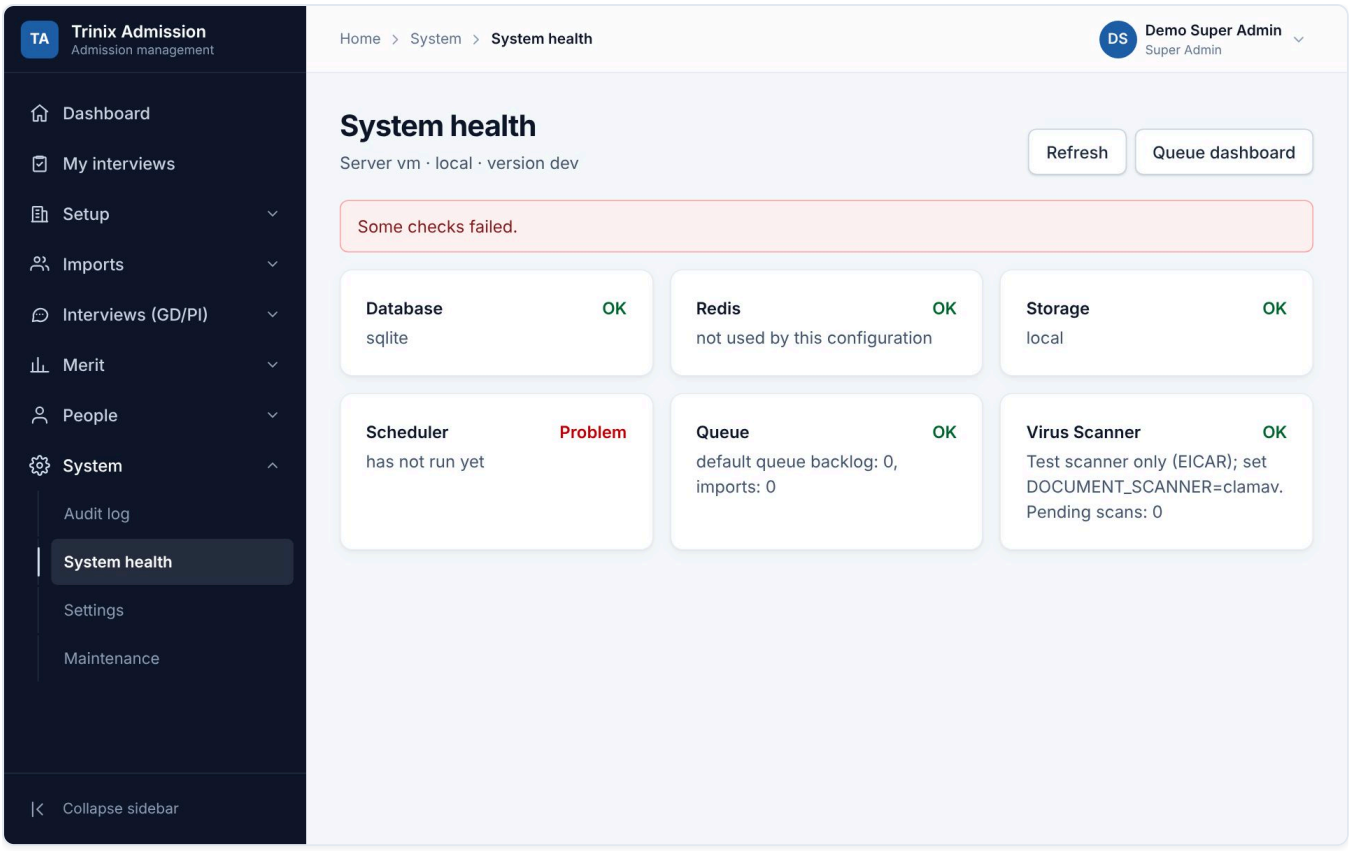


Backups: password, schedule and email, and the backups on the server

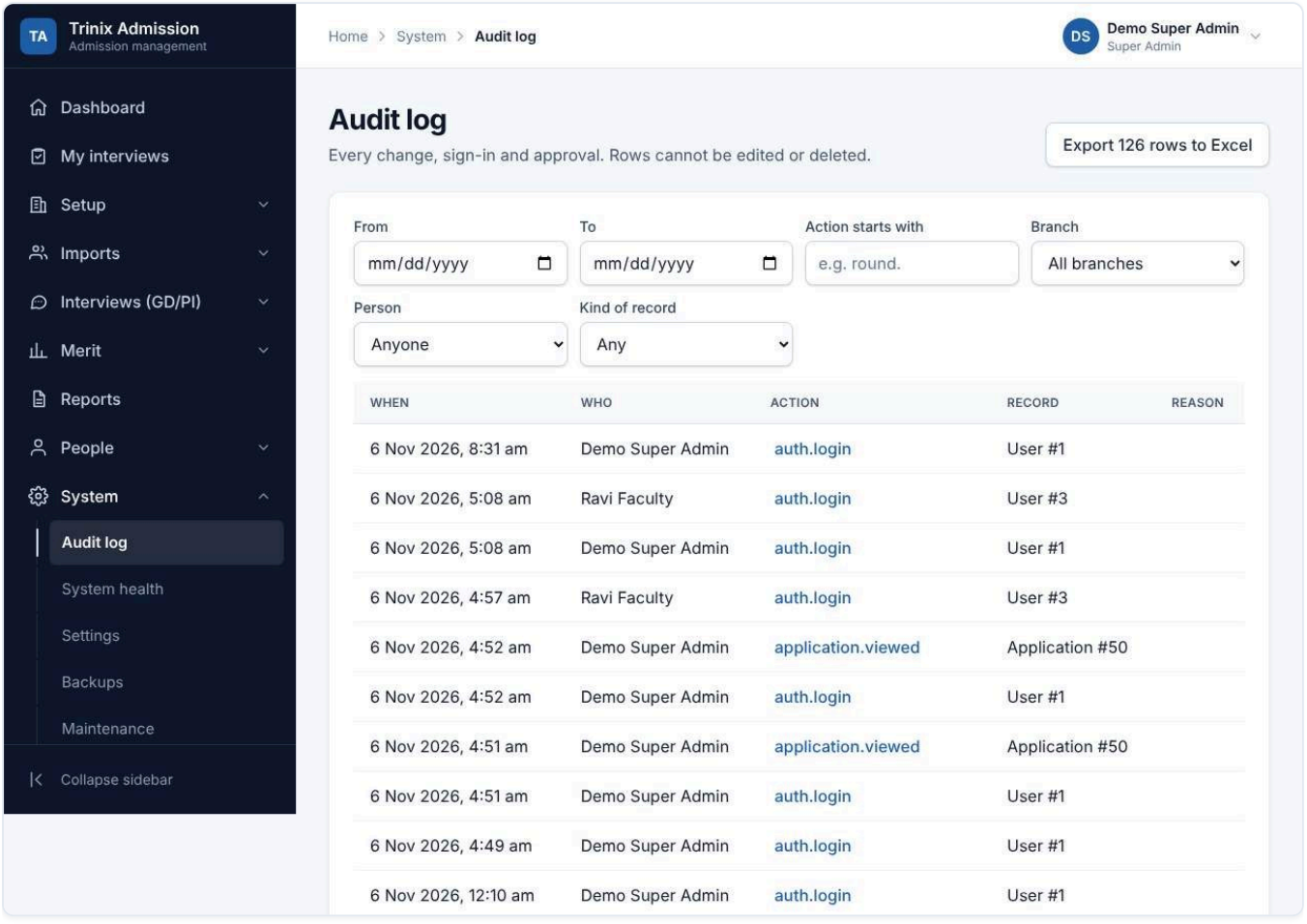
> The daily backup needs the every-minute cron job. **System health** shows a problem when daily backups are off or the last backup is more than a day old. The emailed ZIP holds applicants' personal data: send it only to a mailbox the institution controls.

Health, settings, audit

- **System health**: database, Redis, storage, the virus scanner, the scheduler (cron), the queues and the last backup. A warning here needs IT attention.
- **Settings**: for example the session timeout, sign-in lock rules, invitation expiry, support email, deficiency reply days, and allowed document-link websites. Technical settings belong to the IT Administrator.
- **Audit log**: every change, sign-in, approval, export and backup, with who, when, the old and new values and the reason. Filter by date, action, campus, **person** and **kind of record**, and **Export … rows to Excel** (up to 50,000 rows, with what changed). Rows can never be edited or deleted, and each export is itself recorded.



System health



Audit log with filters for person and kind of record, and the Excel export

Personal data. Applicant data is covered by the DPDP Act 2023. Give accounts only to people who need them, keep the site on HTTPS, use real virus scanning (ClamAV) before real documents are uploaded, and keep the emailed or downloaded backups (and the backup password) in safe places off the server.

CHAPTER 10

Roles at a glance

Each role can be limited to a campus, course and/or cycle. The exact permissions are under **People** → **Roles and permissions**.

Role	2FA	Typical work
Super Admin	Yes	Everything: setup, users (and login sheets), roles, sources, settings, backups and restore, audit
IT Administrator	Yes	System health, technical settings, Maintenance (database updates), unlocking accounts. No applicant data
Central Admission Administrator	Yes	Cycles, rounds, approving imports, files, stages, the schedule, panels, sending emails, locking and reopening marks, merit (all approvals)
Branch Administrator	Yes	Their campus: users and teams, applications, files, panels and scheduling, viewing merit
Committee Chairperson	No	Approving merit formulas, approving and publishing merit lists, viewing and reopening marks, marking
Committee Member	No	Marking candidates on their panels
Admission Cell Officer	No	Imports, applications, files, panels and the schedule, merit formulas and lists (running, not approving)
Admission Cell Staff	No	Applications, files, scheduling and rescheduling interviews
Faculty / Panel Member	No	My interviews: marking own candidates
Reporting Officer	No	Viewing approved information such as merit lists

> The person who uploads an import or runs a merit list can never approve or publish the same item. This applies even to Super Admins.

CHAPTER 11

Questions and troubleshooting

Question	Answer
I cannot see a menu item or a page says "Not found".	Your role or scope does not include it. Pages outside your campus, course or cycle show "Not found". Ask your administrator.
My import stays "Queued" or emails do not arrive.	The every-minute cron job is not running. IT: check System health → Scheduler.
Why can I not approve this import?	You uploaded it. Another person with approval rights must approve it.
An import shows "Updates" for an applicant.	The applicant was imported before and the file has different values. Check them in the preview before approving.
I cannot enter marks for a candidate.	The candidate is not marked Present yet, your marks are already submitted (ask the admin to reopen), or you declared a conflict of interest.
The stage formula cannot be changed.	Results in that stage are already locked. The formula must be set before results are locked.
A merit list says "out of date".	Data changed after publishing (e.g. marks reopened). Run the formula again for a new version and compare.
The schedule upload lists problems.	Fix those rows in the Excel file and upload it again. Nothing is saved until every row is correct.
Candidates did not get their schedule.	Booking does not email. Click "Send schedule emails" for the stage and round when the schedule is final.
A PI booking is refused "must be at the same venue".	The candidate's GD was in person at another venue. Book a PI panel at that venue.
Can a round start before the academic year?	Yes. Admission rounds for 2027-28 can start in December 2026. They must end by the end of the academic year.
Does an applicant ever sign in?	No. Applicants are told their schedule by email; staff reschedule on request.
I lost my phone with the authenticator app.	Sign in with one of your recovery codes, then set up two-factor again under Account. Without codes, ask the IT Administrator.

Terms used

Term	Meaning

Branch / campus	One of the institute's campuses (Delhi, Kolkata, Kakinada, GIFT City)
Offering	A course at a campus in a cycle
Cycle	One admission year's process, e.g. Admissions 2027 for the 2027-28 academic year
Round	A stage of admissions with its own shortlisted applicants and dates (Round 1, Round 2, ...)
Source	Where applicant data comes from, normally the admission portal
Batch	One import (a file or an API push), checked and approved as a whole
Stage result	A candidate's combined GD/PI/WAT result from all panel members, by the stage's formula
Merit list	Candidates ranked by the approved merit formula, per course and round
PwBD	Persons with benchmark disabilities
2FA	Two-factor sign-in: password plus a code from an authenticator app